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HISTORY

Pop Culture 1945–present

INSTANT LESSONS

DISC INSIDE

Rachel Towns

Made for the Australian Curriculum

Achieve! History

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- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills
- ✓ Emphasis on understanding essential History content
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes, providing clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities
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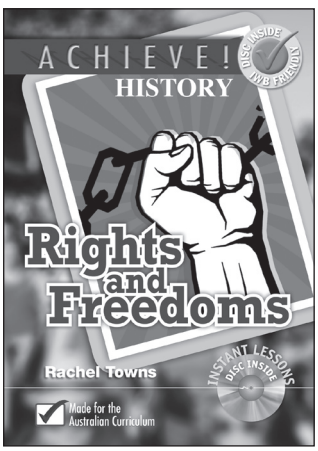

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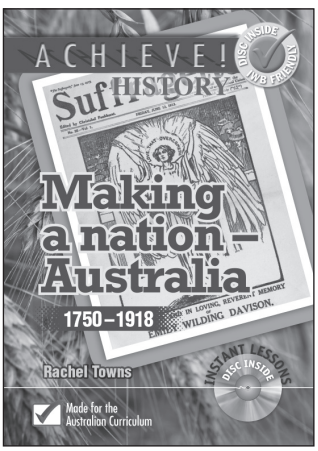

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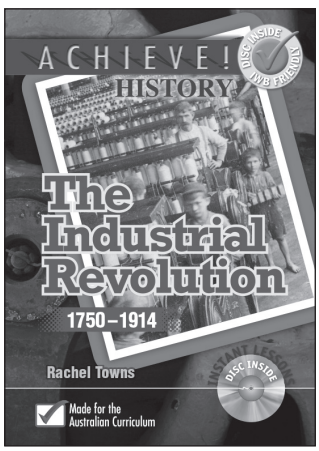

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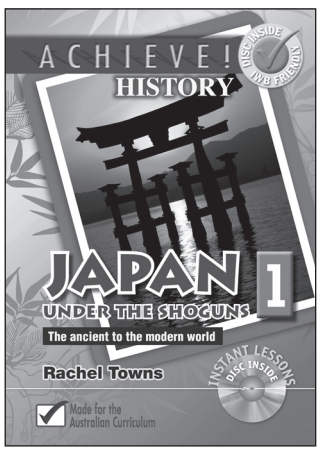

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Rachel works hard to create engaging and accessible material that makes students passionate about history.

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Introduction

Achieve!

The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

Pop Culture 1945–present explores the changing ideas about the culture of ordinary people since World War II, including historians' opinions on the importance of pop culture, the effects of media technology on cultural products like fashion and film, and how Australia's national identity is represented in pop culture. Units about everyday issues like housing and holidays, subcultures, sport and censorship reflect the insights that historians can gain by studying pop culture. Students will examine key events such as the arrival of television in 1956 and the Vietnam War and consider pop culture from the perspectives of the Baby Boomers, and Generations X, Y and Z. Students are also provided with a scaffolded activity to guide them through preparing an essay plan about representations of Australian identity in film.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other work sheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, containing photocopiable Resource sheets and Activity sheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single Resource sheet and related Activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the work sheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and Activity work sheets – The Resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The Activity sheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the students.

Extension ideas – Additional tasks are suggested to recap the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, or to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

The Australian Curriculum alignment	**Unit**									
	1	**2**	**3**	**4**	**5**	**6**	**7**	**8**	**9**	**10**
The nature of popular culture in Australia at the end of World War II, including music, film and sport (ACDSEH027)	✓	✓	✓		✓			✓	✓	✓
Developments in popular culture in post-war Australia and their impact on society, including the introduction of television and rock'n'roll (ACDSEH121)	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Changing nature of the music, film and television industry in Australia during the post-war period, including the influence of overseas developments (ACDSEH122)	✓		✓	✓	✓			✓		✓
Australia's contribution to international popular culture (ACDSEH123)				✓	✓	✓				✓
Continuity and change in beliefs and values that have influenced the Australian way of life (ACDSEH149)	✓	✓		✓	✓	✓			✓	✓

AC

Every effort has been made to also address the specific curriculum requirements of the states and territories.

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I Teacher's notes – Introduction to popular culture

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Objectives

- Develop an understanding of key historical events in Australia
- Consider the connections between key events and popular culture
- Identify useful terms for the study of history

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

The Australia of World War II was largely a monoculture. The 'White Australia' policy that was introduced at Federation in 1901 laid the groundwork for this. Legislation included the *Immigration Restriction Act* 1901which limited non-white immigration and the *Pacific Island Labourers Act 1901* which sent all Pacific Islanders, even those who had lived in Australia for decades, back to their homelands. There were also numerous federal and state laws that limited the rights of the Indigenous Australian peoples. This resulted in the population of Australia in the 1930s and 1940s being over 95% white Anglo-Saxon and primarily descended from immigrants from the United Kingdom. Anyone who didn't 'fit' into this culture was effectively marginalised and expected to take on all aspects of 'Australian' culture if they wanted to be tolerated, let alone accepted.

In the 1930s and 1940s, Australian culture was based on egalitarian ideas such as the 'fair go' and 'mateship'. It was also based on racism, sexism and exclusion. Britain was the main cultural influence. This focus only changed with the new alliances in World War II, when Britain refused to let Australian soldiers return to defend their homeland and the United States supported Australia in the South-East Asian conflict.

Australia's change from a British-style monocultural society to one that was more multicultural occurred slowly. It was aided by stronger links to the United States through Hollywood films, popular television shows and American bands. It was accelerated by changing migration patterns to Australia: the refugees from Eastern European countries after World War II, the Greeks and Italians who came in the 1950s and the Vietnamese who came in the 1970s after the Vietnam War.

It was the arrival of the Vietnamese that led to significant changes in Australia's migration policy and, ultimately, the development of a much more racially and culturally diverse nation.

Australia now has a distinctly international flavour, with the SBS channel, myriad food options, festivals, performances, culture and art.

Starter activity

Have the students watch 'Immigration Nation: The Secret History of Us', episode 1. This documentary explores what Australia was like before World War II. SBS online: www.sbs.com.au/immigrationnation.

Ask students:

- How has Australia changed since 1901?
- What do you think caused these changes?

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'What is popular culture?', introduces students to the concept of popular culture by comparing pop culture in the 1940s and today.

The Activity sheet, 'Why study pop culture?', looks at what historians have decided was significant over time and the change in their focus from politics to pop culture.

The Activity sheet, 'Pop culture in your world', provides students with historical terms and definitions which students then use in descriptions about their own pop culture.

The Activity sheet, 'Key events', provides an extensive list of key events in the history of Australia from 1945 to 2014. Students arrange these events on a timeline.

Students use the timeline they made for the previous Activity sheet to complete the Activity sheet, 'Cultural world'. Here, students link popular culture to historical events and the explanations of their significance.

Extension ideas

Have students walk around the local area and identify and record the elements of pop culture that they see. Work as a class to record these cultural elements on a map.

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Achieve!

What is popular culture?

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the sentences.

Word bank
- 1940
- appeal
- Britain
- general
- music
- pop
- United States

Popular culture is also known as _____ culture. It refers to culture that is based on the tastes and interests of ordinary people. Pop culture's _____, art, fashion and media are easily accessible and _____ to the _____ population.

Before _____, Australian culture was largely influenced by _____, although American music and films were also popular. After World War II ended in 1945, Australians became more interested in the cultural influence of the _____.

2 Complete the table.

Popular culture in the 1940s	Popular culture now
Top grossing films • *Gone with the Wind* (1939) starring Clark Gable, Vivien Leigh. American civil war romance • *Casablanca* (1942) starring Humphrey Bogart, Ingrid Bergman. Political romance • *Spellbound* (1945) starring Ingrid Bergman, Gregory Peck. Mystery thriller by Alfred Hitchcock	**Popular films, actors and genres**
Chart-topping music • Bing Crosby and the Andrews Sisters, 'Don't fence me in' (1944), cowboy-inspired song • Ella Fitzgerald & The Ink Spots; Duke Ellington 'I'm Beginning to See the Light' (1945). Popular jazz song	**Popular music styles and musicians**
Sport • 1945: first Sydney to Hobart yacht race • 23 November 1945: First-class cricket played in Australia for the first time since 1941 • 1945: Carlton wins the 49th Victorian Football League Premiership, defeating South Melbourne in the Grand Final	**What has changed about sport?**

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Why study pop culture?

History is the study of past events. At different times, historians have decided that only certain things were worth studying.

☞ **1** Read the information in the table.

Historians thought it was important to study …		
1800s	**1950s Australia**	**1970s and 1980s, Australia**
Europe and America • Politics (Presidents and Prime Ministers) • Royals (Kings and Queens) • Wars (armies and battles) **Australia:** • European politics and Royals • The Australian landscape	• World Wars I and II • Australian landscape and the rural lifestyle • The way that American culture was corrupting Australian culture	• Wider view of history – more than just politics and wars • Popular culture (music, sport, film) seen to be teaching people about the past

2 Write the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the paragraphs.

In the 1800s, Europe__n and Am__rican historians mainly studied royals and p__liticians because they were the le__ders of their countries. Many A__stralian historians also foc__sed on European and American leaders beca__se they thought that Eur__pean and American hist__ry was more important than Austr__lian history.

In the 1950s, some Australian histor__ans focused on more aspects of Australi__n history. In the 1970s and 1980s, history st__dies broadened ev__n more with a new inter__st in ordin__ry people and the pop c__lture that was based on their l__ves.

3 Explain in your own words why pop culture is important.

_____

_____

4 Suggest why historians changed their focus from just 'important people' to including 'ordinary people' as well.

_____

_____

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Pop culture in your world

The history of pop culture is important because it helps people to understand both the past and the present.

☞ **1** Draw lines to match each historical term to the correct definition.

a bias	• the influence that an event, idea or person has
b censorship	• the years after World War II
c continuity	• having only one culture
d culture	• having many cultures
e impact	• a prejudice for or against a person, group or idea
f monoculture	• the beliefs, values and behaviours shared by a group
g multicultural	• the banning of a book, song or film, often for reasons of morality or law
h post-war	• the things that people judge to be important in life
i values	• when something stays the same over time

2 Describe your own pop culture. Try to use terms from question 1.

3 What values are important to you? List at least two and explain why.

4 Describe a time when you saw someone acting in a biased way. It could be negative or positive bias.

5 When have you experienced censorship? Why did it happen?

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Key events

☞ In your workbook, make a timeline from 1940–2020 and use it to record these events.

1945: World War II ends. The Allies (United States, Great Britain, Soviet Union, Australia) beat the Axis (Germany, Italy, Japan)

1949: Indigenous Australian people become citizens

1949–1975: Snowy Mountains Hydro-electric scheme employs 100,000 workers, many are migrants

1949: ASIO (Australian Security Intelligence organisation) formed

1950s: Myxomatosis, a disease, released to cull rabbits

1954: Queen Elizabeth II's first royal tour of Australia

1954: Vladimir Petrov, a Soviet diplomat and spy, defects to Australia

1956–63: Nuclear testing at Maralinga. Many Indigenous Australian people are affected by radiation and forced from their land.

1962: Indigenous Australian people are given the right to vote in federal elections.

1965: Freedom Ride. Bus ride through NSW to investigate how Indigenous Australian people were treated

1966: Currency changes from the Imperial system of pounds and shillings like Britain to dollars and cents like America.

1969: Equal pay. It became law that women would be paid the same amount as men for doing the same work.

1970: Vietnam War protests held in most capital cities

1974: Cyclone Tracy hits Darwin. The city is largely destroyed.

1976: First boat people arrive, escaping Vietnam after the war. More Asian migration follows.

1983: Ash Wednesday bushfires kill 72 people and destroy 2000 homes.

1984: *Advance Australia Fair* becomes the national anthem

1992: Mabo decision. Lands right case for Indigenous Australian people; *terra nullius* (empty land) defence is overturned

2001: The World Trade Center in New York was attacked by terrorists; almost 3000 died.

2006: Commonwealth Games held in Melbourne

2009: Black Saturday. Massive bushfires throughout Victoria kill 173 people.

2014: Sydney hostage crisis. A man took 18 people hostage at the Lindt Cafe in Sydney. The man and two hostages were killed.

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Cultural world

☞ **1** Look at the timeline you made for the Activity sheet, 'Key events'.
Find the key event that fits with each example of pop culture and its explanation.
Write it in the table.

Key event	Pop culture	Explanation
	They're a weird mob (1966). A film about an Italian migrant in Australia.	Many migrants come to Australia to work on building projects. There was often a culture shock between Anglo-Australians and new migrants.
	American musicians like Bill Haley & His Comets became popular in the 1950s.	Australian culture was originally very close to British culture. But when the United States defended Australia in the Pacific during World War II, it created stronger Australian–American ties.
	In 1978, Cold Chisel performed their song 'Khe Sanh'. It was about Vietnam veterans and their experiences after the war.	The Vietnam war was a big issue in Australia. Many people supported the war against communism, while many others did not. Soldiers were often caught in the middle of this difference of opinion. After previous wars, returning soldiers were celebrated as heroes, but Vietnam veterans were often abused.
	TV show *The Family Law* (2016) stars an Asian-Australian family.	From 1901, Australia's immigration policy was a racist one, restricting non-European migration. After the Vietnam War and and the arrival of the boat people, more Asian migration was allowed.

2 Choose a different event from your timeline. In your workbook, write a description of how this event influenced popular culture.

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2 Teacher's notes – Homes, holidays and healthy lives

Achieve!

Objectives

- Gain an understanding of the different types of housing, holidays and food experienced by Australians
- Consider how elements of daily life shape popular culture and people's experiences
- Consider change and continuity in people's lives

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

Australian culture has been shaped by the houses that people live in. Since the time of the first miners' cottages, buildings in Australia have been made to fit specific purposes and needs.

The original miners' cottages of the 19th century were made for the working class, mainly miners and factory workers. These people wanted a house just for themselves and their families, and usually needed to construct their own. Around Federation in 1901, the middle classes had houses built for them. These often had fancy brickwork in matching red and cream bricks. Other features included scrolled ironwork and wooden floorboards. The aim was to create a sense of age and quality in this newly created nation.

After World War I, the Californian Bungalow became more common as people copied the American style of houses from the newly popular Hollywood films. With its single storey, double fronting and open spaces, it also suited the Australian summers a lot more than the Federation style and miners cottages did. In the second half of the 20th century, brick houses continued to be popular. They leaned towards the 'waterfall' style in the 1950s, with curved windows and walls. In the 1980s, houses became more minimal. They were like large boxes and focused on larger spaces rather than decoration and appearance. It was only in the 2000s that large houses also became more design conscious.

Similarly, food has always been an important part of culture. Jean Anthelme Brillat-Savarin, a famous French lawyer and politician, once said, "Tell me what you eat, and I will tell you who you are." He said this around 200 years ago and it is as true now as it was then. The food we eat is very much shaped by both our national identity and the time period. Although a snag on the barbie may be the quintessential 'Australian' food, it is not necessarily what people in Australia are actually eating. The roasts and three veg of the 1950s changed over the decades and today our diets reflect a wide variety of ethnic influences.

Starter activity

As a class, watch 'Supersizers Eat … The Eighties' (Neil Ferguson BBC 2009, 55 mins. www.youtube.com/watch?v=XG0YG7d1ddc).

This documentary will provides students with an overview of the different foods people ate during the time.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Houses in Australia', shows students three different types of the housing built after World War II. Students use a word bank to complete the information about the housing styles.

On the Activity sheet, 'Where do Australians live?', students consider the reasons for building different styles of housing in different decades. Students then design their own houses to suit people today, giving reasons for their design choices.

The Activity sheet, 'Holidays', identifies key changes in holidays for workers. Students consider these changes and then describe their own holidays.

The Activity sheet, 'Dieting trends', considers how dieting has changed over time. Students use word banks to complete this information.

On the Activity sheet, 'Plan your food', students compare meal habits from the 1980s with their own meal habits then identify features of continuity and change.

Extension ideas

Have students take a picture of their own house. Ask them to try using the features of the house to identify when it was built. Students could make a multimedia presentation about what they found out.

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Houses in Australia

☞ Use the word bank to complete the information.

Word bank				
• bigger	• houses	• rock feature	• study	• veneer
• garden	• lounge	• rooms	• threes	• waterfall
	• open	• square	• two	

1950s Waterfall

- Rounded or curved features gave houses a '_____' look
- The 'rule of _____' – windows, posts or other features were arranged in groups of three
- Generally made of cream bricks, sometimes brown
- Often made from brick _____ instead of double brick
- Usually had three bedrooms, one bathroom and a large _____

1980s Brick veneer houses

- Simple brick houses, often _____ and box-like
- Often houses were two storey to fit in games _____ and second _____ rooms
- Usually made of brown or orange bricks
- Large gardens to display their _____.
- Made from brick veneer because it was cheaper, which allowed for _____ houses.

2000s McMansions

- Often minimalistic, box-like structures
- Extremely large, usually with _____ plan living
- Usually has extra rooms, such as _____ or three bathrooms, a _____ and a home theatre
- Made of a range of materials in neutral colours. Concrete, brick and _____ walls were common.
- Often the house takes up most of the block, leaving a very small garden

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Where do Australians live?

☞ **1** Complete the information about housing by crossing out the incorrect word in each set of brackets.

1945–1950s

- The 'Australian dream' was (owning / own) a home on a quarter-acre block and a car.
- Many first homes were small because their owners (built/ building) them.
- Toilets and laundries (is/were) sometimes outside the main house.

1960s

- Home-building companies started (built / building) cheaper and bigger houses.
- Families could (chose / choose) a design from a catalogue. The suburbs grew quickly.
- Brick veneer became popular because its low cost (allowing / allowed) people to have larger houses.

1980s

- 'Greed is good' was a popular way of (thinking / think).
- People not only (wanting / wanted) to buy a house, they wanted to (buy / bought) a lifestyle.
- Larger houses with separate bedrooms, an office and a games room (were / was) popular.

2000s

- American-style 'McMansions' became popular. These were large houses that (took / taking) up much of the block.
- They (are / had) multiple bathrooms and large indoor/outdoor entertaining areas.
- The owners (believed / believing) that this housing style made it appear that they were (wealthy / money) with high social status.

2 Explain the reasons for the style of housing in these decades.

a 1950s _____

b 1980s _____

c 2000s _____

3 In your workbook, design a house to suit people today. Annotate it with at least five labels to explain what features of your design make it suitable for modern life.

Think about: weather, smaller families, cost of housing in cities, working or studying from home, entertainment spaces, cooking areas and use of the outdoors.

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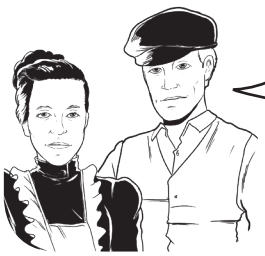
Holidays

Australian workers get four weeks of holidays each year – but this is only a recent thing.



We don't know what a holiday is! I work six days a week, every week. But I have Sundays off to go to church and I don't work on Christmas Day either.

Early 1900s

1930s

The Printers Union got us one paid week off work a year! We'll get a train to see my family who live in the country - we haven't seen them for years.

I get a two-day weekend and two weeks of paid leave. We won't go away though because things are a bit tough after the war.

1945

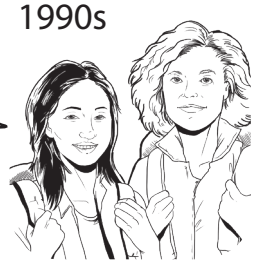
1955

I live in New South Wales and we just got long service leave! If I work for my employer for ten years, I get two months leave. I'm going to see my family in Britain. The ship takes a couple of weeks to get there, though.

1970s

We are using our four weeks annual leave to backpack around Europe. We got some cheap flights with a stop-off in New Delhi.

1990s



2000s

We love travelling up to the Gold Coast for our family holidays. Bruce gets annual leave from his job.

I don't get annual leave or long service leave because I work in two casual IT jobs. I might save up and work remotely from Bali for a while.

☞ **1** How have holidays changed since the early 1900s? List at least three things.

2 What are your holidays like? How much leave do your parents get? What do you do? Write a paragraph about this in your workbook.

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Dieting trends

☞ Use the word banks to complete the information about changes in dieting.

Word bank	Larger	Poor	problem	rich	uncommon	variety	wealthy

Dieting was very _____ before the 1800s. Getting enough fats and carbohydrates was much more of a _____. _____ people ate bread and vegetables, and had meat on special occasions. The _____ could afford a greater _____ of foods, even some from overseas. _____ people were seen as attractive because it meant they were probably _____.

Word bank	available	boyish	corsets	diets	organs

In the 1800s and 1900s, _____ became more common. More food was _____ so it was easier to gain weight. Being thin began to be seen as beautiful and more people dieted. In the 1890s, women used dieting and corsets to achieve the fashionable hour-glass figure. Some _____ were laced so tightly that they cut women's _____ in half. In the 1920s, it was fashionable for women to have a thin, _____ figure. For many women, this required lots of dieting.

Word bank	Atkins	bacon	cabbage	short term	unlimited	vegetables

In the 1950s, the _____ soup diet became popular for _____ weight loss. Dieters would eat just cabbage soup and a limited amount of _____ and fruit for a whole week. In the 1970s, people turned to the _____ diet as a long term eating plan. Many people liked the idea of eating _____ amounts of fatty foods like _____, even if they had to give up all carbohydrates.

Word bank	Beverly	convince	diets	normally	scientific	trend

In the 1980s, _____ like the _____ Hills diet appealed to people who wanted to eat like celebrities. In the 1990s, the Blood Type diet used _____ terms to _____ people to follow it. More recently, people began following the 5:2 diet where they eat _____ for five days, then restrict their food intake for two days. One thing is for sure: next week or next month there will be yet another new dieting _____.

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Achieve!

Plan your food

Even in the 1980s, Australian food was highly monocultural. In many places, the only non-British food available was Chinese takeaway and Italian pizza and pasta.
Here is a meal plan for a typical Australian child in the 1980s.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon.	cornflakes	dim sims (bought), peanut butter sandwich	chow mein (mince with cabbage, noodles, carrots and beans)
Tues.	toast with peanut butter	leftover chow mein, apple	sausages with mashed potato, peas and beans
Wed.	cornflakes	chocolate chip biscuits (3), homemade cheese sandwich	toasted cheese sandwiches
Thurs.	toast with peanut butter	vegemite sandwich, orange	curried sausages (sausage, rice, peas and carrots casserole)
Fri.	cornflakes	chocolate chip biscuits (3), curried egg sandwich	fish and chips (takeaway)

☞ **1** What did you eat last week? In your workbook, draw up a meal planner like the one above. Use it to record your meals from last week.

2 Compare the meal plan from the 1980s with your own meal plan from last week.

a What is similar? _____

b Suggest reasons for the continuity (sameness) of these foods.
(Hint: Consider availability, convenience and cost.)

_____

_____

c What is different? _____

d Suggest reasons for these changes.

_____

_____

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3 Teacher's notes – TV killed the radio star

Objectives

- Gain an understanding of how radio and television technology changed people's consumption of media
- Consider how media programs have changed over time
- Understand how children's television programs are used to educate as well as entertain

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

It is easy to forget how recently television and radio were introduced – the beginning of the 20th century. Although the introduction of both radio and television occurred earlier in Britain and America than it did in Australia, it is important to focus on the introduction of these two forms of media in Australia to understand their significance here.

Guglielmo Marconi patented the first radio in 1896 and the first radio broadcast in Australia was in 1923. The ABC, the pivotal national broadcasting channel, was formed in 1932. By the beginning of World War II, radio was a key part of Australian culture. The declaration of Australia's involvement in World War II was broadcast over the radio on the 3 September 1939. Radio stations became hugely popular in the 1940s and 1950s with 130 radio stations in existence, though the first commercial station (radio station financially supported by advertising) only began in 1953. By 1955, radios were everywhere in Australia and it was estimated that 97% of all Australian households had one.

The year 1956 brought the introduction of television to Australia, the same year as the Melbourne Olympics. Television sets were only available in black and white televisions and they were hugely expensive – about £250 at a time when the average weekly wage was around £15. Despite the cost, the ability to see as well as hear entertainment made them an immediate hit. A common thought at the time was that radios would quickly die out now that television had arrived. Radio remained important entertainment during car trips, but everywhere else it was gradually replaced by the TV. In the 1940s and 1950s, families sat around the radio in the evenings. Now they sat around the television.

The high cost of televisions made them status symbols but also led to a community atmosphere. Many people without televisions would visit friends who had them in order to share the experience of watching key events such as the Olympics. In 1960, just four years after television was introduced, 1,000,000 television licences were bought. The introduction of colour television in 1975 added another layer to the level of entertainment.

Starter activity

Listen to an old-fashioned radio broadcast. You can find some examples at:
www.nfsa.gov.au/collection/curated/women-radio

Ask students to identify the intended audience for the show. Then discuss the strengths and weaknesses of radio as a media source.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Radio and television in Australia', introduces a timeline for the arrival and use of radio and television in Australia. Students then compare and contrast the development of these mediums.

The Activity sheet, 'Radio hour', explores radio programs from the 1920s and 1930s. Students will complete a table to show how similar content is delivered today.

The Resource sheet, 'Children's hour', looks at two long-lasting children's television programs: Australia's *Play School* and America's *Sesame Street*.

The Activity sheet, 'My show', follows on from the Resource sheet. Students plan their own educational television program for children, highlighting the features they will use to interest, educate and entertain.

On the Activity sheet, 'Aussie, Aussie, Aussie', students read about three significant Australian soap operas and answer questions about them.

Extension ideas

Make your own radio broadcast for the 1940s. Remember to choose a specific audience (children, women, men, families) and purpose for your show. It could be a news report, comedy act, drama, interview with a famous person or children's program.

Web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

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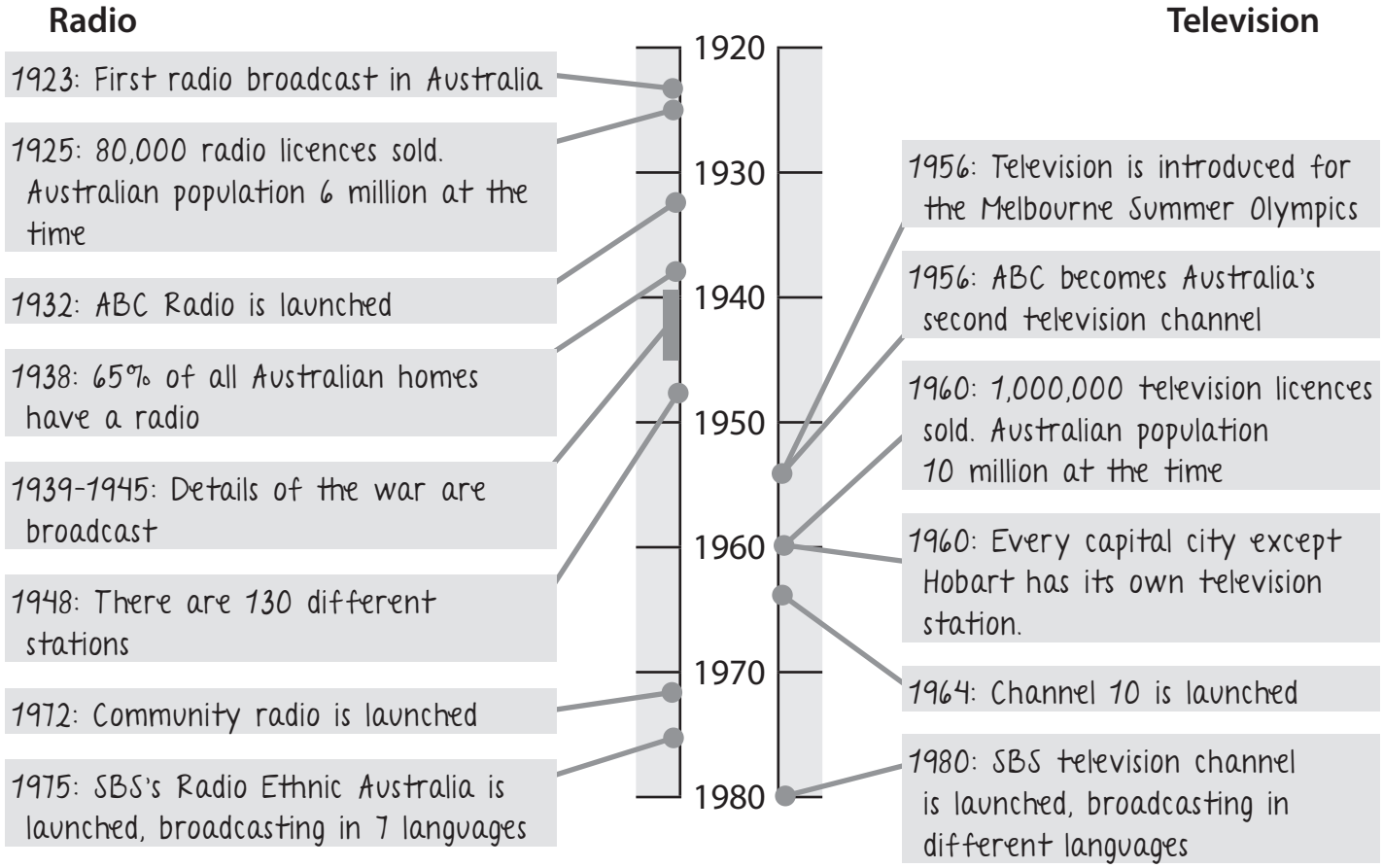
Radio and television in Australia

Radio, 1924

- Radios cost £1–£4 (equivalent to $75–$300 today)
- The annual licence cost 35 shillings (equivalent to almost $130 today).
- The minimum weekly wage was about £4 (equivalent to $307 today)

Television, 1956

- Televisions cost about £250 (equivalent to $7550 today).
- The annual licence cost £5 (equivalent to $155 today).
- The minimum weekly wage was about £12 (equivalent to $362 today).



☞ Complete these activities in your workbook.

1. Compare the cost of a radio and licence to a television and licence.
2. Which one costs a larger proportion of the average weekly wage? Explain your answer.
3. Think about the development of radio and television in Australia. How was it similar? How was it different?

Terminology

licence: people originally had to pay a fee to use radio and TV

Imperial currency: money used in Australia before 1966, based on British currency

twelve pence = 1 shilling

twenty shillings = 1 pound (£1)

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Radio hour

After newspapers, radio broadcasts were the main source of information and entertainment. The radio program schedule was structured around who might be listening at that time.

☞ **1** For each row in the table, briefly explain:

- if the content is still provided
- where else the target audience can get this information.

Some examples have been included to get you started.

1920s and 1930s	Today
Women **When:** During the day when women were alone at home. **What:** Programs like *Banish Drudgery* gave housekeeping hints; serialised stories and popular music programs for entertainment	Better homes and gardens *television show provides handy hints for both women and men*
Children **When:** During the afternoon and evening **What:** Birthday greetings, songs and things to make and do; Uncle George told bedtime stories	
Radio serials **When:** In the evenings for family entertainment **What:** Plays and stories, with multiple actors reading for characters	
News reports **When:** Usually at 7.00 pm, serious content for adults. **What:** Current news events, local and national; information about local social events	*News is less serious, often includes entertainment clips like dogs surfing*

2 Do people listen to radio shows today? How, when and why?
Write a paragraph about this in your workbook.

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Children's hour

As television entered almost every house in the 1960s, many people wanted children's shows that were educational as well as entertaining. These shows were often targeted at pre-school children, giving them the skills they needed for school. Australia's *Play School* and America's *Sesame Street* are two of the longest running children's shows in the world.

Show	Play School	Sesame Street
When	1966 to now	1969 to now
Where	Australia	United States
Who watches	Aimed at Australian pre-school children, aged 3–6	Aimed at lower-class children who were struggling to receive pre-school education, aged 3–6.
Presenters	• Usually two presenters that speak to the camera. • Some presenters have been there for over 30 years. • Presenters became more racially diverse in the 1990s with Indigenous Australian and Maori presenters. • Often famous Australian actors worked as presenters.	• A neighbourhood of female and male, racially diverse presenters: African-American, Hispanic and White. • Some actors have been on the show for its entire history. • Muppets (monster puppets) also live in the neighbourhood.
Education	• Uses clocks to learn time • Emphasises on learning through play • Shows crafts and chooses windows to promote creativity, choice and imagination • Has themes of the week	• Focuses on numbers and letters of the day to teach literacy and numeracy • Teaches about relationships and issues • Includes Spanish language • Uses educational studies to support its programs
Format/ content	• Toys are used to tell stories • Presenters sing songs • Has short films about real-life experiences	• Colourful puppets are the main characters • Celebrity guest appearances • Songs and dances

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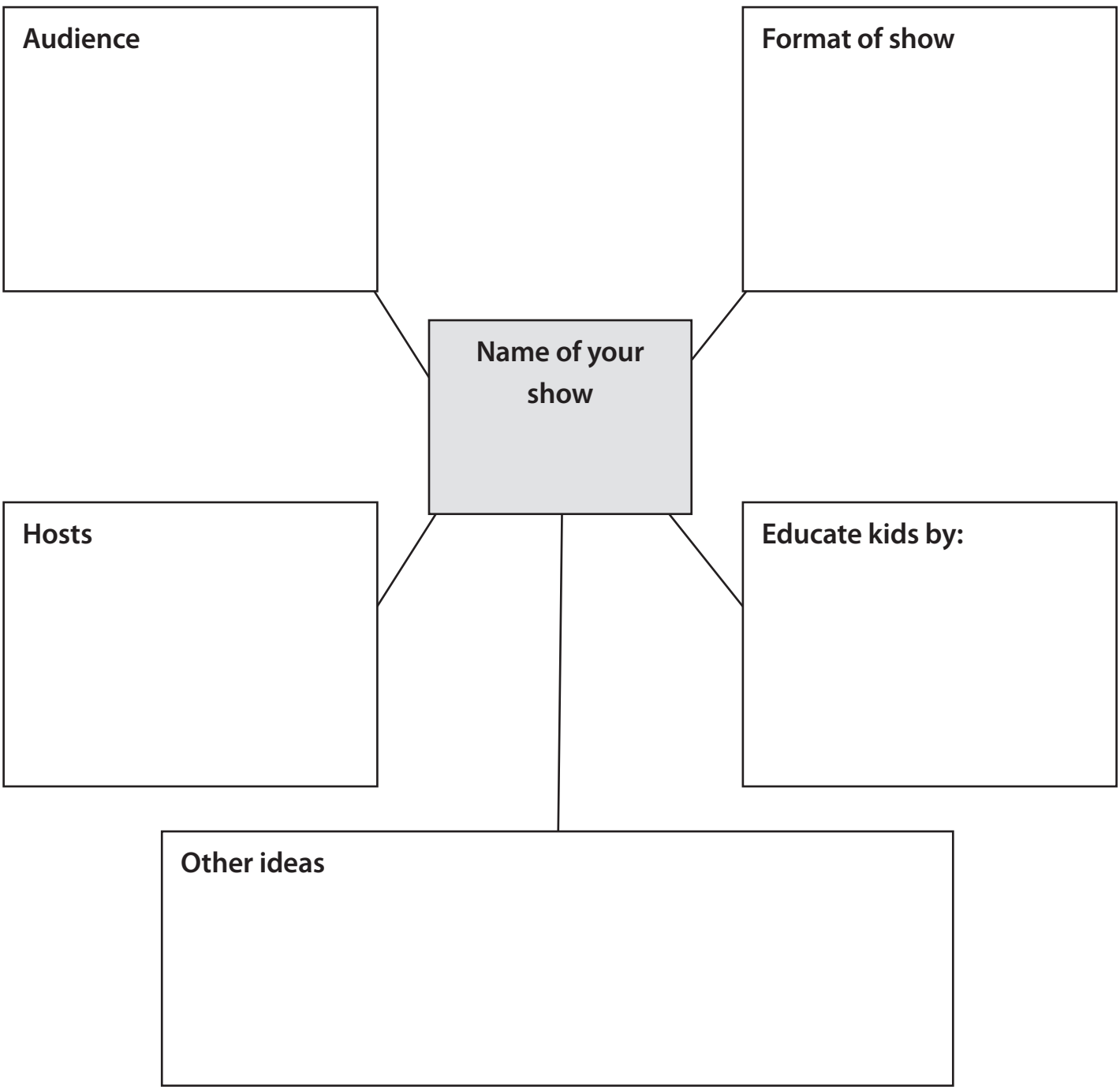
My show

☞ **1** Use the Resource sheet, 'Children's hour', to inspire a plan for your own educational television program for children. Some categories are included on the mind map to get you started.



2 In your workbook, write a short script for the opening of your show. It should introduce your show and its presenters or characters to your audience.

3 Design a poster or short film to promote your show.

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Aussie, Aussie, Aussie

Soap operas are television shows that focus on the everyday lives and relationships of characters in a particular town, family or location. There is often a new episode on each day.

☞ **1** Read the table about Australian shows and answer the questions.

***Number 96*, 1972–1977**	***The Sullivans*, 1976–1983**	***Home and Away*, 1988 to now**
1,218 episodes • Followed the lives of people living in a small block of flats in Sydney, NSW • Focused on the relationships they had with each other in the apartment building • One of first shows in the world to feature an openly gay couple • Had a multiracial cast, which was unusual at the time	1,114 episodes • Followed the lives of the Sullivan family who lived in Camberwell, Victoria • Focused on family relationships and their experiences in World War II • Strong focus on historical accuracy in the props and drama • Very successful in the UK, shown in 30 other countries	Over 6,700 episodes • Follows the lives of five foster kids in Summer Bay, NSW • Focuses on how the townspeople and the kids from the city get used to each other • Very successful overseas, shown in over 80 countries • Recent ratings have gone down as the target audience tends to watch online

2 What made each of these shows significant?

Number 96	***The Sullivans***	***Home and Away***

3 What has changed about soap operas since the 1970s?

4 *Number 96* had a more multicultural cast than *The Sullivans* or *Home and Away*. Suggest reasons for this.

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4 Teacher's notes – Music

Objectives

- Consider the changes in musical styles from the 1950s to the 1960s
- Understand how Australian musicians communicated ideas about social issues and fought for change
- Identify key music genres that shaped the 1970s

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

In the 1930s and 1940s, the Australian music scene was dominated by British performers. Australians often copied British musical styles as there was a feeling that their musical culture was superior to our own. In the 1950s, American singers like Bill Haley & His Comets had a greater influence. Apart from the resurgence of the British style that Beatlemania brought in the 1960s, the American focus continued with bands like the Jackson 5 in the 1970s and Nirvana in the 1990s.

For much of Australia's history there has been conflict between a sense of 'cultural cringe' and a sense of pride in our culture. The latter is shown through the desire to support our cultural industries by instituting a requirement for television and radio shows to perform a certain percentage of Australian content.

However, Australian musical performers have often been compared to the musicians of the United States and Britain and perceived as imitators and followers rather than innovators and creators. Australian band The Easybeats were seen as second-hand Beatles, while Australian punk rockers The Saints saw the American band the Ramones as having the same musical ideas and yet being given all the credit. Similarly, Australian grunge bands in the 1990s like Silverchair found it hard to compete with the American band Nirvana.

Starter activity

As a class, listen to Australian music from different eras. Some suggestions are listed below.

- 1950s: Johnny O'Keefe
- 1960s: The Easybeats, The Bee Gees, Little Pattie
- 1970s: Billy Thorpe and the Aztecs, Daddy Cool, Skyhooks, AC/DC
- 1980s: John Farnham, Mental as Anything, Midnight Oil, Crowded House, Hoodoo Gurus
- 1990s: Powderfinger, Silverchair, Christine Anu, Ben Lee, Baby Animals, Killing Heidi
- 2000s: Jet, Missy Higgins, Sarah Blasko
- 2010s: Wolfmother, King Gizzard and the Lizard Wizard, Tame Impala, Gotye, Jessica Mauboy

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Bill Haley vs The Beatles', provides two primary sources and a secondary source to explore how these bands affected Australia in the 1950s and 1960s.

Students use the Resource sheet to complete the Activity sheet, 'Rock'n'roll riots and Beatlemania'. Here, students answer questions about the sources and explore the nature of primary and secondary sources.

The Activity sheet, 'Seventies style', provides an overview of the 70s musical styles disco, metal and punk.

On the Activity sheet, 'Disco, metal and punk', students use the information on the previous Activity sheet to help them design posters and write lyrics that fit with each of the three music styles.

On the Activity sheet, 'Social issues', students explore the way some Australian musicians have supported social issues.

Extension ideas

Have students work in small groups to create a music video for an Australian song. They could choose a song by any of the musicians and bands listed in the starter activtity, or another Australian performer.

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Bill Haley vs The Beatles

In 1957, Australia faced a huge rock'n'roll experience when American band Bill Haley & His Comets came to Australia. Many parents were concerned that bands like this would turn their children into rebels and criminals. In 1964, this fear was increased by the extreme Beatlemania of the fans when British band The Beatles came to Australia for the first time.

Source 1

But Bill Haley who wants to see rock'n'roll catch on in Australia, doesn't want to see riots. 'I never HAVE seen riots,' pronounced big smooth-faced Bill Haley who sports a C (for Comet) shaped lock of hair down the centre of his forehead. 'Let me tell you about some so-called riots… Inside the Ballpark where we were playing were 11,000 kids, Outside because they didn't have the money to go in were two teenagers. When the police asked the two kids to move off, these two kids smashed a soft drink bottle against a wall … All seven of the Comets are married – six out of the seven are fathers.'

Helen Frizell, 'Please no riots says American Rock'n Roll King', *Australian Women's Weekly*, 23 January 1957

Reproduced with permission from Bauer Media Pty Limited / *The Australian Women's Weekly*

Source 2

In June 1964, The Beatles toured Australia. Huge numbers of fans turned up to their performances, flight arrivals and even their hotel rooms. This obsessional fan behaviour was labelled 'Beatlemania'. Over 30,000 people waited to catch a glimpse of The Beatles when they performed at the Town Hall in Adelaide. At the time, the band said that this was the largest welcome they had ever received. When The Beatles performed, audiences were often so loud with their screaming, stamping and singing that many people could not actually hear the band playing.

Rachel Towns, *Achieve History: Pop Culture 1945–present*, Blake Education, 2018

Source 3

Parents who always moan about their teenagers listening to Beatle records don't seem to remember that when they were young they listened to songs with titles like 'Marsey Doats and Dosey Doats'.

Songs like this weren't even based on a good story, so please 'Marsey Doaters' give The Beatles a fair go. Join in and you'll soon be enjoying singing their bright clear songs also – Beat Teen Mount Gambier S.A

'Mad Oldies' Letters', *Australian Women's Weekly*, 10 June 1964

Reproduced with permission from Bauer Media Pty Limited / *The Australian Women's Weekly*

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Rock'n'roll riots and Beatlemania

☞ **1** Label each statement as true (T) or false (F).

a Many kids were trampled at the Bill Haley & His Comets concert. ☐

b The Beatles' first concert in Australia was in 1964. ☐

c Bill Haley & His Comets' first concert in Australia was in 1958. ☐

d 30,000 people saw The Beatles perform in Canberra. ☐

e Bill Haley was described the King of Rock and Roll. ☐

2 Read these quotes. What do you think each speaker is trying to tell their audience?

'All seven of the Comets are married – six out of the seven are fathers.' (Source 1)

'Parents who always moan … don't seem to remember …' (Source 3)

3 Sources 1 and 3 are primary sources. This means that they were written at the time and about the time.

Why are primary sources useful? Use examples from Source 1 or 3 to support your answer.

4 A secondary source is a source written after the time and about the time. A textbook is an example of a secondary source.

Why are secondary sources useful? Use examples from Source 2 to support your answer.

5 Use the information on the Resource sheet to write your own secondary source about Bill Haley & His Comets and The Beatles visiting Australia. Write two paragraphs that suit the style and purpose of a school textbook.

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Seventies style

Three distinctive music styles emerged during the 1970s and had a significant impact on this decade. These three styles were **disco**, **metal** and **punk**.

	Disco	Metal	Punk
When	Mid 1970s to mid 1980s	Started in the late 1960s / early 1970s	Started in the late 1970s
Significant international bands	• ABBA • Boney M. • KC and the Sunshine Band	• Black Sabbath • Iron Maiden • Metallica	• The Clash • Sex Pistols
Australian bands	• The Bee Gees	• Bengal Tigers	• The Saints
Musicians' appearance	• Bright shiny clothes • Large gold jewellery • Big hair	• Often had long hair and wore leather clothes	• Short messy hair • Ripped clothing with zips, spikes and safety pins
Features of the record covers	• Multi-coloured dance floors • Disco balls • Big shiny writing	• Images of devils, dragons and gothic writing	• Images of violence, anarchy and riots
Features of the music	• Dance music • Pop and funk • Songs about romantic relationships	• Loud, screaming style • Songs about anger and death	• Loud, provocative style • Songs about rebellion, revolution and taboo topics

☞ Watch the music videos of at least one group from each style.
In your workbook, answer the questions for each group.

1 Do you like it? Explain why.

2 What modern musicians have similar music? Think about both sound and what their songs are about.

3 What modern musicians have a similar image?

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Disco, metal and punk

☞ **1** Use the information on the Activity sheet, 'Seventies style' to help you design a record cover or promotional poster for a disco band, a metal and a punk band. Annotate each design to explain your choices.

2 Choose one of these topics. Write lyrics for your topic that would suit each of the three musical styles.

Topics:				
• dreams	• relationships	• the future	• living in the suburbs	• a famous person
	• social media	• your passions		

Disco lyrics	Metal lyrics	Punk lyrics

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Social issues

☞ **1** Listen to each of the songs shown in bold in the information below.

2 Answer the questions in your workbook.

In 1971, Australian songwriter **Helen Reddy** released a song called **'I am woman'**. This song became incredibly important because of its lyrics about the strength and capabilities of women, and its reminder that women do make up half of the population. Many in the feminist movement in the 1970s and 1980s celebrated this song as an anthem that inspired women to take an equal place in society.	**1** Why was the song 'I am woman' taken up as a rallying cry by the feminist movement?
In 1983, **Redgum** released the song **'A walk in the light green'**, commonly known today as **'I was only 19'**. This song focused on the experiences of Australian soldiers in the Vietnam War by drawing attention to the conscription age for the army. John Schumann, the lead singer, used his own experiences as a Vietnam veteran to write the song.	**2** This song addresses both the Vietnam War and conscription. What are these two issues? Why are they so important?
In 1991, Indigenous Australian band **Yothu Yindi** released their song **'Treaty'**. This song focused people's attention on the rights of Indigenous Australian peoples. It is about the hope for a treaty between the Australian government and Indigenous Australian peoples to begin addressing the racial inequality in Australia.	**3** A treaty is a legal agreement between two groups. Why do Yothu Yindi and other Indigenous Australian peoples want a treaty?
In 2016, **Missy Higgins** released her song **'Oh Canada'**. It was a response to the images of a three-year-old Syrian refugee who drowned while trying to escape to Canada. All the profits were donated to the Asylum Seekers Resource Centre.	**4** What social issues are important to you? Why?

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5 Teacher's notes – Cinema and censorship

Achieve!

Objectives

- Develop an understanding of changes in the Australian film industry
- Identify international influences on the Australian film industry
- Consider the nature of celebrity

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

The Australian film industry was initially quite successful. In the 1900s, almost anyone could become a filmmaker if they had enough money for the cameras and could convince people to act for them. Most of these first films were 'one-reelers', so ran for 10–12 minutes. Australia was also the location of the first full-length film in the world: *The Story of the Kelly Gang*. This golden period of filmmaking in Australia lasted only until the 1920s. Around this time, the Hollywood film studios began eclipsing the abilities of local filmmakers.

In the 1970s, the Australian government realised they needed to provide funding for filmmakers in order to support the Australian film industry. After that, some significant Australian films were made and they achieved local and international success. These films included *Mad Max* (1979), *Crocodile Dundee* (1986), *The Adventures of Priscilla, Queen of the Desert* (1994) and *Animal Kingdom* (2010). Also during that time, Australian actors such as Nicole Kidman, Russell Crowe, Guy Pearce, Chris Hemsworth and Margot Robbie have become renowned international performers.

When discussing film, censorship is also a relevant topic. Censorship refers to the way that the media is controlled and restricted. The restrictions on what people could and couldn't access was more extreme in Australia in the early 20th century. Restrictions were relaxed somewhat in the 1970s when classification (such as G, PG and M ratings) was emphasised over censorship. Some texts, films and video games are still censored, but few cannot be accessed at all. One exception is *The Peaceful Pill Handbook*, 2006. This book was 'Refused classification' and therefore can't be published and distributed in Australia. It was censored because it provides advice on euthanasia and as of 2017, there are no laws in Australia that allow euthanasia.

Starter activity

Ask students about the Australian films they have seen. Do these films have any elements in common?

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet, 'Australian film industry', identifies the stages in Australia's film history from the 1900s to the 2000s.

Students use the Resource sheet to complete the Activity sheet, 'Ocker Aussies'. Here, students answer questions about Australia's film industry.

The Activity sheet 'Hollywood, Bollywood and Nollywood', provides students with an overview of these three key centres of filmmaking.

On the Activity sheet, 'Censorship and classification', students find out what censorship is and its history in Australia. Then they consider how censorship affects Australians today.

Students use the previous Activity sheet to help them complete the Activity sheet, 'To censor or not to censor?'. Here, students answer questions about censorship and then compose a speech that either supports or argues against censorship.

Extension ideas

Have students visit Australian Screen Online at https://aso.gov.au.

Ask them to choose two Australian movies from different periods, read the information about them and watch the short clips.

Then students should write a brief report that answers the following questions.

- How do these films represent Australian culture?
- What changed between these time periods, in terms of both Australian culture and filmmaking styles and techniques?

Web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

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Australian film industry

1900s–1920s: Innovation

In the 1900s, anyone could enter the film industry if they could buy the equipment. Most films were 'one-reelers' which meant they were only about 12 minutes long. The Australian film *The Story of the Kelly Gang* (1906) was the first full-length feature film in the world.

1940s–1960s: Imitation

Australian–British or Australian–American films such as *The Sundowners* (1960) were made in Australia. Uniquely Australian films were less common and often centred on stereotypical Australiana like the kangaroo in *Skippy and the Intruders* (1969). One exception was *Jedda* (1955) which was the first film to star two Indigenous Australian actors. Another was *They're a Weird Mob* (1966). This was a comedy that explored the problems that Italian migrants encountered in Australian society.

1970s: Golden years

In the 1970s, the Australian government realised that the film industry needed their support. Many films made in the 1970s were ocker adventures like *The Adventures of Barry McKenzie* (1972) which relied on stereotypes and rude humour. Other films were more literary and artistic, like *Picnic at Hanging Rock* (1975). The critical success of these films paved the way for the funding of more popular films like *Mad Max* (1979).

1980s–1990s: Australia goes international

In the 1980s, Australian films like *Mad Max 2* (1981) and *Crocodile Dundee* (1986) became very popular overseas. Australia was idealised as an exciting, exotic location. This image of glamour extended into the 1990s with the ballroom dancing in *Strictly Ballroom* (1992), ABBA's music in *Muriel's Wedding* (1994) and the drag queens of *The Adventures of Priscilla, Queen of the Desert* (1994). These films showcased a very different version of Australia.

Australia in the 21st century

Many films made in the Australia in the 2000s and 2010s focused on Australian criminality: serial killers, families of criminals and hitmen. These films included *Chopper* (2000), *Wolf Creek* (2005) and *Animal Kingdom* (2010). However, there have also been heart-warming stories about unlikely heroes and underdogs such as *The Sapphires* (2012), *The Dressmaker* (2015) and *Lion* (2017).

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Ocker Aussies

☞ Use the Resource sheet, 'Australian film industry', to answer the questions.

Multiple choice – tick your answer.

1 When were ocker films made?

- 1950s
- 1960s
- 1970s
- 1980s

2 Why was the 1970s known as the golden age of film?

- The government funded the film industry.
- The government banned the film industry.
- Americans made more exotic films.
- The British made more exotic films.

3 *They're a Weird Mob* was different to other films in the 1960s because other films usually focused on:

- Italian immigrants.
- stereotypical Australian content.
- including multicultural elements.
- ballroom dancing.

4 In the film *Crocodile Dundee*, Australian Mick Dundee travels to the United States and shows them some Australian customs. It was a significant film because:

- it supported the crocodile industry.
- it was very popular overseas.
- it challenged stereotypes.
- it glamorised Swedish pop music.

Fill in the blanks

5 There were two types of films in the 1970s: _____ adventure films and more _____ films. *Picnic at Hanging Rock* is an example of an _____ film. In the 1990s, Australian films challenged previous ideas about Australian culture. This was shown by the _____ in the film *The Adventures of Priscilla, Queen of the Desert* (1994) and the characters fighting to compete in a ballroom dancing competition in the film _____.

Short answer

6 What are Australian films like today?

_____

_____

7 How is this different to Australian films in previous decades?

_____

_____

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Achieve!

Hollywood, Bollywood, Nollywood

☞ **1** Use the word bank to complete the information.

Word bank
- African
- Australians
- Bollywood
- cheap
- film
- Hollywood
- India
- musical
- Nollywood
- *Spectre*
- thousand
- *Wonder Woman*

In 1912, filmmakers began moving to _____ near Los Angeles. They wanted to leave New Jersey and the restrictive rules that inventor Thomas Edison and his company placed on filmmakers.

The land around Hollywood was _____ and could be made to look like different locations, so it was easy to _____ there. Hollywood films became hugely popular and were shown all over the world. _____ loved watching American films, often treated them as the pinnacle of cinema. Lately there has been a focus in Hollywood on superhero movies like _____ (2017) and big budget action movies like _____ (2015).

Hollywood is not the only centre of filmmaking. _____ is the nickname of the Indian film industry, linking the Indian city of Bombay with Hollywood. Films have been made in _____ since the early 1900s, but it was only in the 1990s that Bollywood films gained international appeal. These films often focus on love stories, _____ numbers and dance moves.

_____ is the name give to the Nigerian cinema industry. It produces over a _____ films each year, focusing on _____ culture and actors.

2 What types of films do you watch?

_____

3 Why do you watch them? What makes them entertaining? Include specific examples in your answer.

_____

_____

4 How do Nollywood, Bollywood and Hollywood influence Australian popular culture?

_____

_____

_____

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Censorship and classification

Censorship is when someone controls what you can read, write, listen to or watch. When you were a child, your parents may have stopped you from watching shows that were intended for adults. This is a kind of censorship.

☞ **1** Cross out the incorrect words in bold so that the information about censorship make sense.

The Australian government has **censored / supported** materials over the years, usually due to violence, sexuality or political views. Censored materials **cannot / must** be published or distributed. Some people approve of this as they believe it protects people from **boring / dangerous** material. Other people disapprove of censorship because it means they **must / cannot** make their own decisions about what they read, watch or play.

In 1929, *Lady Chatterley's Lover* by D. H. Lawrence was **censored / published** because of its sexual content.

In the 1969 case Crowe vs Graham, four men were fined for **publishing / hiding** parts of censored books.

Because of the Graham case, in 1972 the **government / cinemas** began using a classification system instead of **censoring / giving** materials. This system tells you which materials are suitable for different audiences: G (General, suitable for everyone), PG (Parental Guidance recommended), M (Mature, recommended for people aged 15 and over), MA 15+ (restricted to people aged 15 and over), R18+ (Restricted to people aged 18 and over) and RC (Refused Classification – banned).

In the 2000s, some gamers made **compliments / complaints** because games were being **banned / sold** due to extreme **cuteness / violence**, sexuality and other problematic content. Some games that were originally rated as RC and **celebrated / banned** were permitted under a R18+ rating in 2011.

2 Answer these questions in your workbook.

a How does censorship affect popular culture?

b When do you think books, movies or games should be censored? Give reasons for your opinion.

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Achieve!

To censor or not to censor?

☞ Use the information on the Activity sheet, 'Censorship and classification', to help you complete these tasks.

1 Choose one of these topics.

- Censorship is wrong because it restricts our right to choose the pop culture we watch, read and play.
- Classification helps to protect people from watching the 'wrong' material. It is a useful guide for people and helps them to decide which pop culture is good for them.

2 Do you agree with your chosen topic? _____

3 Give three reasons for your answer.

- _____
- _____
- _____

4 Write a speech to convince other people to agree with your point of view.
Useful words: demand, rights, suggest, encourage, consider, understand, change

a Introduce your topic. _____

_____

b Write two or three sentences that relate to each of the reasons you listed above. Use evidence to support your reasons.

Evidence
- quotes from books, websites or interviews
- statistics
- anecdotes (personal stories)

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

c End your speech with a powerful, persuasive statement.

_____

_____

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6 Teacher's notes – Sporting nation

Achieve!

Objectives

- Develop an understanding of how sport has changed in order to become more inclusive
- Identify significant moments in Australia's sporting history
- Creatively explore the idea of Australia as a sporting nation

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

Australia has long been seen as a sporting nation. This identity has been embraced by many people, as can be seen in the invention of the new sport Australian Football and in the wide range of other sports that are played in competitions throughout the country.

From the very beginning, Australians have participated in both local and international competitions. When the Olympic Games were restarted in 1896, Australia sent athletes. Many of the first Olympic competitors were self-funded but later the Australian government provided financial support for them. In 1912 the Olympics was opened to female competitors and Australian's Fanny Durack and Mina Wylie were among the first women to compete. Australia has often been quite successful in the Summer Olympics, especially in swimming with Dawn Fraser, Shane Gould, Ian Thorpe, Susie O'Neill and Kieran Perkins all achieving fame. In 1924 the Winter Olympics were introduced. Australia was less successful here, waiting until 2002 for Steven Bradbury and Alisa Camplin to win the first two gold medals.

The year 1930 brought the first Commonwealth Games which was open to all the nations in the British Empire. These games gave Australia an opportunity to shine, as one of the Commonwealth's pre-eminent sporting nations.

The Paralympics began in 1948. Originally it was a competition for British paraplegics. It has since expanded to become a worldwide competition that is paired with the Olympics.

Australia has always valued sports. In 1981, Australia committed further to the identity of a sporting nation by establishing the Australian Institute of Sport (AIS). This AIS works to develop the sporting potential of Australian athletes.

Starter activity

Show students some images of significant sporting events. Discuss why these moments were so significant and what they tell us about the Australian identity.

For example:

- Cathy Freeman running with the Aboriginal flag
- Steven Bradbury winning the 1000 m Speed skating
- Nicky Winmar lifting his shirt to show his pride in his Indigenous Australian identity
- Ian Thorpe winning the 400 m Freestyle at the Sydney Olympics
- Makybe Diva winning the Melbourne Cup for the third time
- An AFL Grand Final and/or Rugby Grand Final

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Australia the sporting nation', asks students to create a visual representation of Australia as a country with a focus on sports and sporting competitions.

The Activity sheet, 'Melbourne Cup', provides key facts about the Melbourne Cup for students to add to a timeline.

The Activity sheet, 'Changing AFL', explores the way this game has evolved over time, and the changing role of women and Indigenous Australian players in this sport. and female players have been included more as the game has progressed.

The Activity sheet, 'Melbourne Olympics', features a primary source that discusses the differences between the Olympics in Ancient Greece and the 1956 Melbourne Olympics.

The Activity sheet, 'He's done a Bradbury', looks at Steven Bradbury's speed skating win in 2002 – the first time Australia won a gold medal in the Winter Olympics. Students then consider different perspectives on this race.

The race: 'The most unexpected Gold medal in History', www.youtube.com/watch?v=fAADWfJO2qM.

Interview with Bradbury: 'Last Man Standing', www.youtube.com/watch?v=-wn9fDwnT3k

Extension ideas

Have students research a sport that they are interested in, and compile a multimedia report to show their findings. They should include a timeline of the history of the sport, a profile of a famous person, interesting facts, a quote and an explanation and a brief analysis of changes in the sport over time.

Web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

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Australia the sporting nation

Australia has often been described as a sporting nation. Sport is certainly important in our society. Many people find a sense of community through the teams they follow, the sporting competitions they play in and the local competitions they attend.

In the international field, Australians excel at lots of swimming and athletics events. Sports such as cricket, soccer, hockey, netball, rowing, equestrian and rugby sevens have also allowed Australia to shine.

☞ Make a mind map to explore the idea: **Australia is a sporting nation.**
Some ideas are included to get you started.

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Melbourne Cup

☞ Write each event in the correct place on the timeline.
Use the underlined keywords for your labels. One has been done for you.

1861: The first Melbourne Cup is held on the first Tuesday in November.

1930: Phar Lap wins the Melbourne Cup. He was a hugely popular champion.

1942–44: The race is held on a Saturday during World War II.

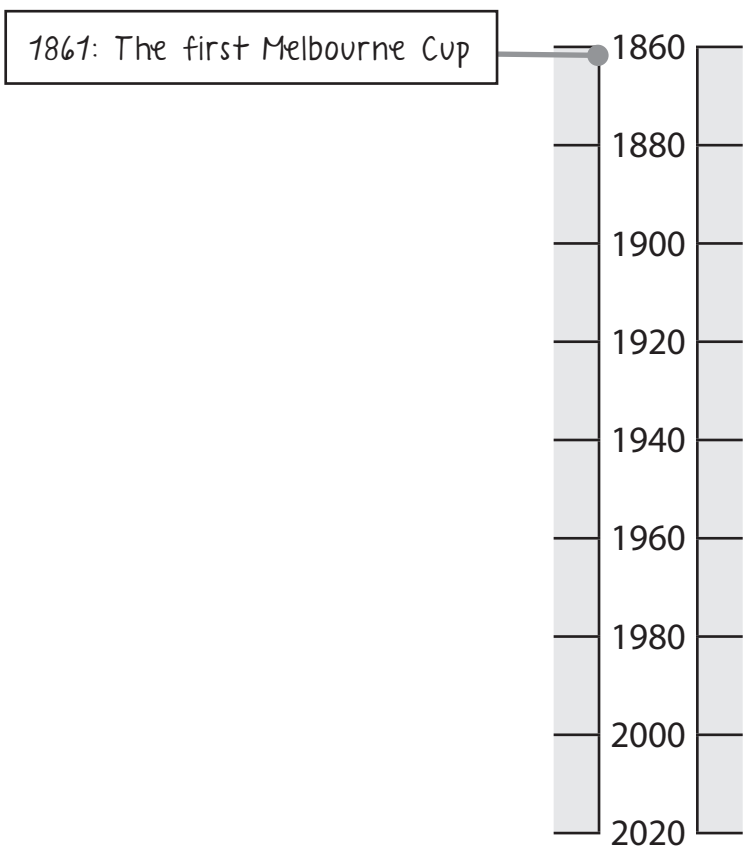
1948: First photo finish at the Melbourne Cup.

1960: First live broadcast of the Melbourne Cup.

1973: Frank Reys becomes the first Indigenous Australian jockey to win, riding Gala Supreme.

1987: Maree Lyndon becomes the first female jockey to compete, finishing 20th on Argonaut Style.

2015: Michelle Payne becomes the first female jockey to win, riding Prince of Penzance.



Extra activity: Which event on the timeline do you think is the most significant? Research the topic and find evidence to support your opinion. In your workbook, write two paragraphs arguing for your event.

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Changing AFL

☞ **1** Write the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the information.

The sp__rt of AFL (A__stralian Footb__ll League) is only pl__yed in Australia. It was inv__nted in 1857 as a way to keep crick__ters fit during wint__r. The game quickly gained in p__pularity in Vict__ria. The Victorian Football Le__gue was formed in 1896 with the te__ms Carlton, Collingwood, Essendon, Fitzroy, Geelong, M__lbourne, St Kilda and So__th Melbourne. In 1987, the league w__s expanded to includ__ the non-V__ctorian clubs West Co__st Eagles and Br__sbane Bears. In 2011, the new teams G__ld Coast Suns and Greater Western Sydn__y Giants made a total of 18 teams in the nation__l comp__tition.

2 Read the information about women and Indigenous Australian players in AFL.

Women	**Indigenous Australian players**
• Women play football but there has been little support for competitions. • 1981: Victorian Women's Football League (VWFL) was formed. • 2017: First female professional teams are Adelaide, Brisbane Lions, Carlton, Collingwood, Fremantle, Greater Western Sydney, Melbourne and Western Bulldogs. • 2017: Annual pay for most female footy players was $5000. The highest pay was $25,000. Average annual pay for male footy players was $300,000. • 2017: Hannah Mouncey, a transgender player, was refused entry to the 2018 AFLW draft. • 2019: Teams from Geelong and North Melbourne joined the competition.	• Today, Indigenous Australian people make up 2% of the general population but 9% of AFL players. • Some people believe AFL is based on the Indigenous Australian game *Marngrook*. • 1904: Joe Johnson becomes the first Indigenous Australian player. • 1906–1980: A total of 18 Indigenous Australians played in this period. • 2005: Dreamtime at the 'G matches begin – annual games between Richmond and Essendon that celebrate Indigenous Australian culture. • 2013: Indigenous Australian player Adam Goodes is called an 'ape' by a spectator. Racism is still an issue today.

3 Use the information on this page to write a report about changes in AFL since 1857. You could research further information to add to your report.

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Melbourne Olympics

In 1956, the Summer Olympics were held in Melbourne, Australia. This was an important time for Australia – for the first time, elite athletes travelled from all over the world to compete in Melbourne and Ballarat. Television was introduced to Australia that same year so people could watch the races instead of just listening to them on the radio.

☞ **1** Highlight the keywords in the source below. Keywords are the important words that tell you what a sentence is about. The first paragraph has been done for you.

Women and Olympics

After almost four years of bickerings, recriminations and gloomy forebodings of one kind or another, the Olympic year has finally dawned – and peacefully at that.

It is now pretty certain, come what may, nothing can take the Olympic Games from Melbourne. For the first time in history, Australia in staging games with almost 3000 years of tradition behind them, is about to enjoy a spot of the glory that was Greece.

We suspect, though, that this glory as Melbourne will see it would cause a sharp shift of amazement to the classic eyebrow of any ancient Greek …

The Grecian village of Olympia was off-limits to women. On pain of death, no female dared show her nose inside Olympia even as a spectator, let alone as a competitor.

It is true that one determined type, undoubtedly the spiritual ancestress of all feminists, did get herself not only into the village, but also into a chariot race which she had the tactlessness to win.

This finished the Games as far as Greek women were concerned. But obviously not as far as Australian women are concerned.

They are taking an almost 50–50 part in these Games as competitors, as organisers, as hostesses, as officials.

That they will fully justify the responsibilities given them we have no doubts at all. And in doing so they'll demonstrate one glory that Greece never knew – the equal rights of women.

'Women and the Olympics,' *The Australian Women's Weekly*, 18 January 1956

Reproduced with permission from Bauer Media Pty Limited / *The Australian Women's Weekly*

2 Write a paragraph about how the involvement of women in the Olympics changed from Ancient Greece to Melbourne in 1956 to now. You could research the most recent Olympics to help you write in more detail.

He's done a Bradbury

In 2002, Steven Bradbury won the 1000-metre Speed skating at the Winter Olympics in the United States. It was Australia's first Winter Olympic gold medal. Stephen was also in the relay skate team in 1994, winning Australia's first medal in the Olympic Winter Games – bronze.

☞ **1** Watch a video of Steven Bradbury's victory in the 1000-metre Speed skating. Identify the emotions you see.

Steven's emotions	The audience's emotions	The other skaters' emotions

2 How would you feel if you were Steven?

3 Watch a video of Steven Bradbury discussing the race. Is his reaction what you expected? Give reasons for your answer.

4 Write a postcard to Steven Bradbury, telling him about the emotions you felt while watching this race.

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7 Teacher's notes – Fads, fashions, fast food and fiction

Achieve!

Objectives

- Understand abut how Australians spent their leisure time in the 20th century
- Consider both change and continuity in fashion
- Identify key fads and how they shaped their decades
- Consider what food and fiction tell us about a time period

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

The popular culture of Australia is very much shaped by people's leisure pursuits. Fashion is one area in which celebrities and the media have a great deal of impact.

In the 1950s and 1960s, Australia was slow to adopt fashion changes and often ended up a couple of years behind the stylemakers in the United States and Britain. In 1965, Jean Shrimpton caused great controversy when she appeared at Derby Day at Flemington Racecourse wearing a mini dress andno tights or gloves. In Britain, this look was not controversial. In conservative Australia, it was shocking.

In the late 1960s and 1970s, fashions for both men and women became more exciting and colourful. Then fashion moved towards a 'big business' look in the 1980s. In the 1990s and 2000s, the internet brought Australian fashion trends closer into alignment with those of the United States.

Fads (briefly popular items) have always played a role in popular culture, highlighting the need for people to show that they are part of the 'in' group through the possessions that they own. Often these fads target children with toys such as yoyos, Pet Rocks, Furbies and fidget spinners. Some fads, like Beanie Babies and Pokémon GO, also appealed to adults.

Fast food has also played a significant role in the development of popular culture. With its emphasis on cheap, familiar and easily accessible food, fast food has had a strong appeal for mainstream Australia. This has happened in a relatively short period of time. In 1968, KFC became one of the earliest franchises to arrive in Australia. Before fast food arrived in force, most people ate all their meals at home. Take-away options were generally limited to fish and chips or Chinese and they were only common in larger centre.

Reliance on novels for entertainment has decreased with technological advances, but novels are still a significant feature of pop culture. Memoirs like Kathy Lette and Gabrielle Carey's *Puberty Blues* (1979) were pop culture texts for the young people who read them. They also described the pop culture of a specific time and place. Similarly in the 1990s and 2000s, series like JK Rowling's Harry Potter and Suzanne Collins' The Hunger Games became best sellers as people created a cultural movement around them.

Starter activity

Collect fashion pictures for both women and men from the 1950s, 60s, 70s, 80s, 90s, 00s, 10s. Have the students identify which decade each image is from, and to give reasons to support their answer.

When the images are organised into the correct decades, attach them to the wall as a visual timeline.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Changing fashions', looks at how women's fashions changed between the 1960s and the 1980s as well as the continuity between these decades. As an extension activity, discuss with the students how women are seen because of their clothes. For example, are they seen as homemakers or professionals? Fun or serious? Attractive or powerful? Childlike or adult?

The Activity sheet, 'Men's fashion', looks at male clothing from the 1950s and 1970s. Students explore how different groups may have viewed these changes.

On the Activity sheet, 'Fads', students will fill in the names of fads in sentences about changing fads from the 1950s to the 2010s.

The Activity sheet, 'Fiction', guides students through the process of exploring the language use and cultural context of a quote from *Puberty Blues* by Gabrielle Carey and Kathy Lette (1979).

The Activity sheet, 'Fast Food', looks at the dates of arrival of some fast food chains and the locations of their first stores. Students use this information to identify trends and consider changes in fast food consumption over time.

Extension ideas

Have students choose a fad and prepare a one-minute speech that explains what it is and why it was popular.

Students could choose from those listed on the Activity sheet, 'Fads', or research a fad that was popular in a different country.

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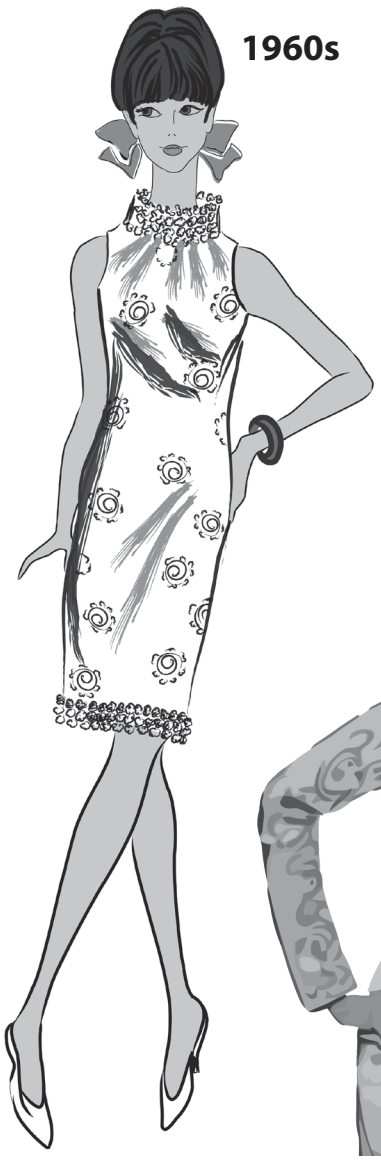
Changing fashions

Women's fashion has changed much over the decades. What was popular in one year could look odd and unusual just a couple of years later.

☞ **1** Draw a line from each term in the word bank to the illustration it relates to.

1960s



1960s © Terriana | Dreamstime

Word bank

- 'greed is good' time period
- big hair, lots of hairspray
- bigger is better
- business suits
- hippie time period
- more women working, better pay
- pantyhose
- short shift dresses
- shoulder pads to look stronger
- women not encouraged to work

1980s

1980s © Amuzica | Dreamstime

Change: What are the differences over time?

Continuity: What has stayed the same?

2 In the boxes to the right of the illustrations, list the things that have changed and the things that have stayed the same.

3 In your workbook, write a paragraph to compare and contrast women's clothing in the 1960s and 1980s. Use at least three comparative terms in your paragraph.
Comparative terms for similarities: also, similarly, like, both
Comparative terms for differences: in contrast, however, in comparison, although

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Men's fashion

In the 1600s and 1700s, men's fashion was as exciting and unusual as women's. However, in the 1800s and early 1900s it became more restricted. Society expected men to be sober and serious. They wore clothes in neutral colours – brown, navy blue and black – with simple cuts like suit pants and jackets.

☞ **1** Read what Henry and Kevin have to say about male fashion.

Henry, 1950s

I wear a suit and tie when I go out with my girl, Winnie. There aren't many colours to choose from – most suits only come in black, brown and navy blue. I often use brylcreem to style my hair neatly on the side. I want to look good and that means I need to look neat and clean.

I like colourful clothes. I'm wearing a t-shirt in bright colours. My Dad Henry likes to dress as if it's still the 1950s, but I like clothing that is a bit more fun. My favourite singer is David Bowie and he's worn dresses and skirts. I haven't done that, but it's interesting all the same. I wear tight flared pants and sometimes even platform shoes when I go out with Mary-Lou. Although some guys still wear brown, blue and black, I like that we can wear colours like mustard yellow, forest green, pale blue and maroon red.

Kevin, 1970s

Answer these questions in your workbook.

2 In the 1950s, what did Henry want to wear?

3 In the 1970s, what did Kevin want to wear?

4 What was different about Henry's and Kevin's clothes?

5 How do you think Henry and Kevin would have viewed each other's clothes?

6 Why has society expected men to be sober and serious?

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Fads

A fad is when something quickly becomes popular with lots of people, then loses its popularity, often just as quickly.

☞ Use the fads to complete the information. You may need to do some internet research to work out the answers.

Fad bank

- Beanie Babies
- Beyblades
- Bratz dolls
- Cabbage Patch Kids
- Care Bears
- fidget spinners
- Furby
- hula hoops
- Lego
- Pet Rock
- Play Doh
- Pong
- Rainbow Loom
- Rubik's Cube
- Sea-Monkeys
- Slinky
- Tamagotchis
- Teenage Mutant Ninja Turtles
- Uno
- yo-yos

1950s: Many children became obsessed with _____ and _____ – both being materials that let them build things. The _____ was also very popular. It was made of a spring coil from building supplies.

1960s: Fads were all about things that could twist and spin. _____ were wooden circles on strings that could be made to do tricks. _____ were rings that you swung around your hips.

1970s: Different kinds of pets suddenly became popular with the _____, which was hardly a pet at all, and _____, which were actually brine shrimp in an aquarium. Arcade games like _____ also gained in popularity.

1980s: The _____ puzzle with its multicoloured squares became a hit. Then it was all about toys from television shows: _____ were kids born in a garden, _____ were bears who looked after the emotions of others and the _____ lived in a sewer and had adventures fighting crime.

1990s: Collecting soft bears known as _____ was all the rage. In schools, _____ were frowned on because kids spent too much time looking after their electronic pets.

2000s: Electronic pets evolved in the 2000s with the _____ – a furry version of the Tamagotchi. _____ were marketed as a modern version of Barbie and people battled each other with the spinning tops called _____.

2010s: More recent fads include the _____, which lets children make their own bracelets, and _____, which people twist to give them something to focus on. Another recent fad is the card game _____.

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Fiction

Before films, the internet and video games, books were the main way of telling stories in our society. They are still important, not only for the stories they tell, but also for what they say about the time that they were written.

Puberty Blues by Gabrielle Carey and Kathy Lette was published in 1979. It is an autobiographical story about their experiences as 13-year-old girls who wanted to fit in with the surfing culture of Sydney.

> The beach was the centre of our world. Rain, snow, hail, a two-hour wait at the bus stop, or being grounded, nothing could keep us from the surf. Us little surfie chicks, chirping our way on the train. Hundreds of us in little white shirts, short-sleeved jumpers, thongs, straight-legged Levis covering little black bikinis. We flocked to the beach. Cheep. Cheep.

From *Puberty Blues* by Gabrielle Carey and Kathy Lette, Text Publishing Company and Random House Australia, 2012, p. 1.

Definitions

grounded: punished by being made to stay home

chirping: a happy sound made by a bird

flocked: moved in a large group (often refers to birds)

☞ **1** What is happening in the quote?

2 a How is language used by the writer? Highlight these words in the quote to help you:
- chirping
- chicks
- little black bikinis
- flocked.

b What is the effect on the reader of using language in this way?

3 a How are females represented in this quote?

b What does this tell you about the way the writers saw themselves?

4 What does this quote tell you about the time the book was written?

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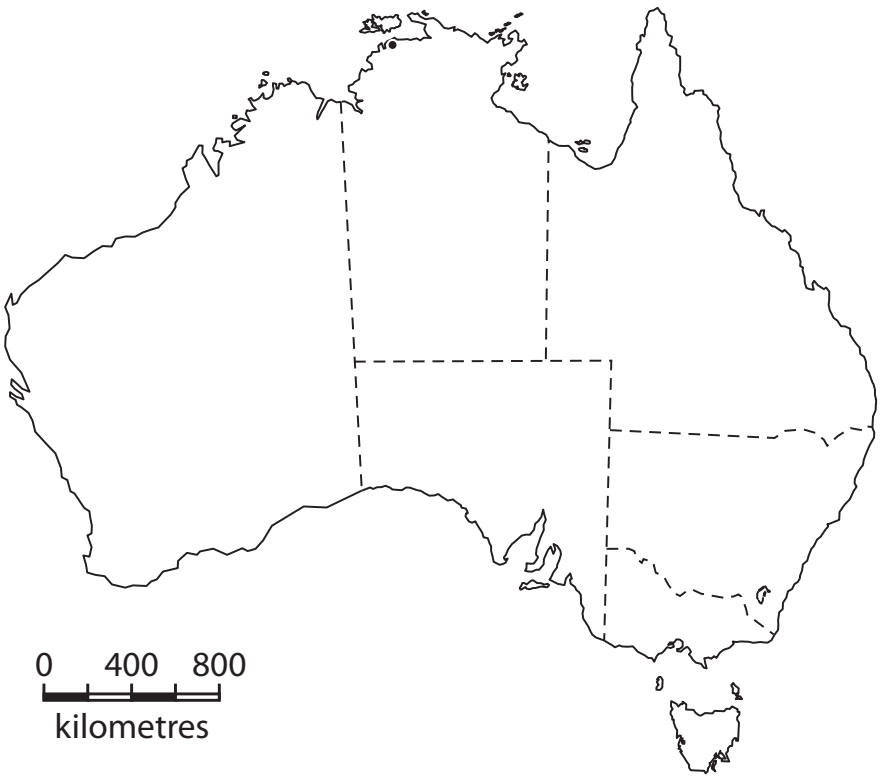
Fast food

☞ **1** Use an atlas to locate the first fast foods on the map.

2 Label each place with the name of the fast food and number them from 1 (earliest arrival) to 6 (latest arrival). Then label the states and territories.



Fast food firsts

1968: KFC, Guildford, Sydney, New South Wales

1971: McDonalds, Yagoona, Sydney, New South Wales

1971: Burger King arrives with a name change to **Hungry Jack's**, Innaloo, Perth, Western Australia

1972: Red Rooster, an Australian invention, Kelmscott, Perth, Western Australia

1990: Nando's, Tuart Hill, Perth, Western Australia

2000: Boost Juice, an Australian juice and smoothie bar, Adelaide, South Australia

3 What do you notice about the locations and dates? Describe the pattern or trend.

4 How has fast food changed since 1968?

5 What sort of takeaway do you think people ate before 1968? Explain your answer.

6 How do you think fast food trends will change in the future? Make a mind map in your workbook to record your ideas.

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8 Teacher's notes – Technology and culture

Achieve!

Objectives

- Understand how technology has changed since the 20th century
- Consider the impact of technology on pop culture
- Understand how certain technological items help to create a sense of identity

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

The technological advances of the 20th and 21st centuries have been dramatic and significant. When we stop to consider just how many changes there have been, it is almost mind blowing. Technology has contributed a great deal to pop culture as it increased the range and type of media people could access: television, films and music.

Just 100 years ago, people in Australia did not have televisions, mobile phones, radios or the internet. Films were only just being introduced and they were generally short (10–12 minutes) and silent. Some wealthy people had access to phonographs (wind-up record players).

Few radios were sold in Australia until the 1920s and the first broadcast was in 1923. Black-and-white televisions were introduced in 1956, with colour arriving in 1975. Most people went to the cinema to experience movies in colour, which started in the 1930s.

Domestic technological advances were also significant because they freed all people, but especially women, from the drudgery of never-ending household chores. This provided greater opportunities for people in terms of work and education, but it also gave people time for leisure and recreation.

Devices such as fridges, ovens and vacuum cleaners were important for the freedom they provided but also they led to a different kind of restriction. Owning these things became a badge of social identity. The particular brand, colour, style and age of a product soon signified who you were and your place in society.

Starter activity

Lead a class discussion about the impact of technology on modern life. What would life be like without the internet, tablets and smartphones? How would people experience pop culture without these devices and services?

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Changes in the home, changes in our world', looks at how different features of household technology have changed over time. Students complete internet research on the topic, then consider the impacts of these changes.

The Activity sheet, 'Entertainment', provides a television timeline and information about the development of television in Australia.

On the Activity sheet, 'Communication', students consider how technology has change the way that people communicate over distance.

The Activity sheet, 'Technology and identity', gets students to research advertisements for a technological device. Students then consider the identity that is associated with their device, and how it has changed over time.

Extension ideas

Invent a new piece of technology that you think will be useful in the future. Draw a design of your invention and label the features to show how it will work and how it will change people's lives.

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Changes in the home, changes in our world

In the past women were expected to stay at home to look after their family and to cook and clean. Over time, appliances such as vacuum cleaners, washing machines, ovens and microwaves became more advanced and quicker and easier to use.

Many women found it easier to get an education and a job outside the home when they did not have to spend so much time cooking and cleaning. They also had more time to consume popular culture in the form of films, books and music.

Image © Valeriy Kachaev | Dreamstime

☞ Use a search engine to explore how housekeeping technology has changed since 1945. Use search phrases such as 'washing machine history'.

1 What has changed about washing clothes?

2 What has changed about how we cook food?

3 What has changed about the way floors are cleaned?

4 Are there any elements of these devices that have stayed the same? Why?

5 How do you think popular culture influenced the purchase and use of these machines?

6 In your workbook, make an annotated drawing of a home appliance from the year 2060. What features of your invention might give families more leisure time?

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Entertainment

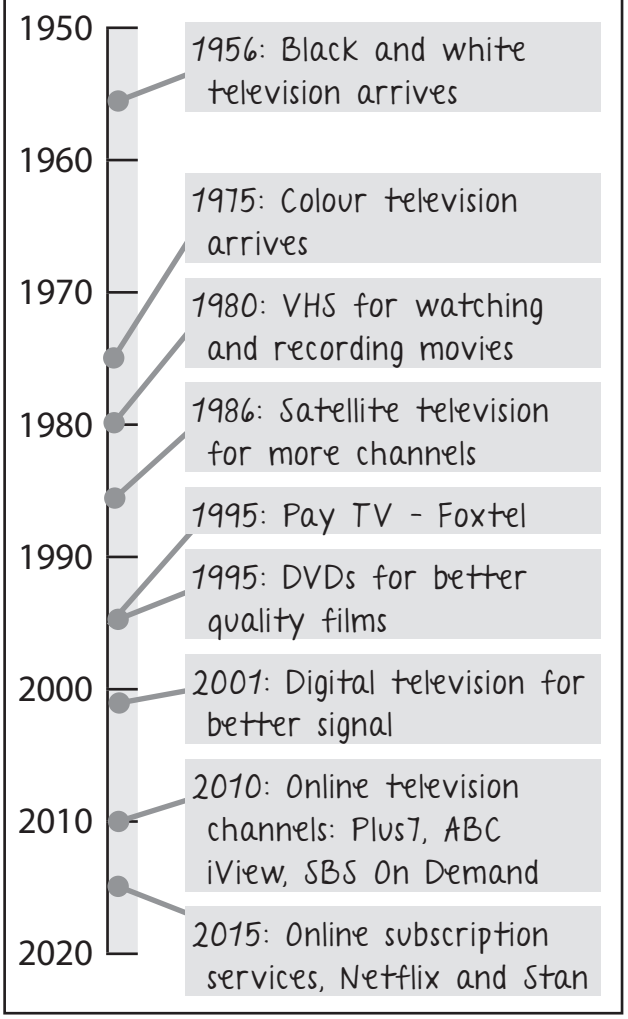
With the development of technology, entertainment activities moved from reading, writing and playing to listening to radio and finally to watching television.

Television was introduced in Australia at the same time as the Melbourne Olympics in 1956. This meant that people could now see the events as well as listen to them.

At first, there were three channels: ABC (originally ABN), Nine (originally TCN-9) and Seven (HSV7). Channel Ten was introduced in 1964. In 1980, the SBS channel was created to broadcast content targeted at multicultural audiences.

To support Australian culture and identity, the Postmaster General decided in 1960 that 40% of programs on Australian television channels had to be made in Australia.

Technological developments



☞ **1** What did people do for entertainment before television?

2 What has changed about television channels over the decades?

3 Who decided there should be Australian content on television? Why?

4 Which event in the television timeline do you think is the most important? Explain why.

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Communication

☞ Read what Eileen and Rachel have to say about communication.

I am on holiday at Lake Tyers beach with my kids. My husband Lance works during the week and comes out to stay with us on the weekends. I often send letters or postcards to my friend Carmen in Melbourne to let her know how our holidays are going. Sometimes it take two or three days for her to get my letters and then another two or three days until I receive a reply from her.

Eileen, 1967

I am on a holiday in Bali with my husband and son. Sometimes when I want to chat to people, I get on Facebook, Messenger and Snapchat or just call them. It is so easy to contact people when we're away - I hardly have time to get homesick.

Rachel, 2017

Imagine you are on holiday at your dream destination and something exciting happens.

1 Write to your best friend about what happened, as if you were sending a postcard.

2 Now send the message as if you were using a text or social media.

3 What is similar and different about your messages?

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Technology and identity

Often, people choose products not only for what they can do, but for the image associated with that particular brand or device. Some new products are aimed at people who want to see themselves as part of the tech elite – innovative and up to date with the latest gadgets. Some products, like a retro wooden record player, might be marketed at people who want to see themselves as unique, edgy and counterculture.

☞ **1** Choose a technological device, such as a phone, tablet, car or sound system.

- Research advertisements online for your device.
- Find advertisements from two different decades, such as the 1990s and 2000s.

	Device:	
	Decade:	**Decade:**
What does the item look like? Colour / shape / materials / features		
What does the advertisement look like? (Sales techniques)		
How does the advertisement make the buyer feel? What identity does it convey?		

2 Compare and contrast the advertisements. What has stayed the same? What has changed? Why?

3 In your workbook, create your own advertisement for a device that you want. Annotate your design with labels to explain the identity you think it gives to buyers.

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9 Teacher's notes – Subcultures

Achieve!

Objectives

- Gain an understanding of different subcultures of the 20th century
- Consider how groups defined themselves in opposition to each other
- Understand how different groups consumed popular culture in different ways

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

Our experiences of popular culture are often defined by the groups we choose to associate with. Many groups have their own carefully defined uniform (clothing and hairstyles), interests (sport/recreation/films) and culture (behaviour/music).

In almost every decade, distinct and significant groups have stood out from the others. In the 1950s there were bodgies (boys) and widgies (girls) who copied American rock'n'roll culture. Their style of denim jeans and leather jackets for boys and tight black skirts with looser tops for girls are reminiscent of the styles worn in the film *Grease*. This was one of the first groups directed at Australian teenagers. Previously, people moved straight from childhood to adulthood, taking on responsibilities and jobs early. The 1950s brought the idea of the teenager as a distinct age of freedom, rebelliousness and search for identity.

In the 1960s a more distinctly Australian culture began with the surfie movement. Surfies were primarily male with females generally treated as girlfriends rather than surfers in their own right. This group continued well into the 1970s.

Often there was a distinct battle between the values and views of the parents and their children, as their different experiences led them to interact with the world in different ways. This was a significant feature of the Vietnam War. Many teenagers and young adults protested the war, while many older people supported it as a way to defend democracy and protect Australia from communism. It is important to remember that this was a general trend only, and many people had opposite views. For example, a group of mothers formed the Save Our Sons movement, 1965–1975, and called for an end to conscription and the Vietnam War.

Another group that emerged in the late 1970s was the punk movement. It began in Britain and soon spread to both Australia and the United States. It appealed to disenfranchised youth who were attracted by the angry lyrics, brightly coloured hair and ripped clothing.

The Goth movement emerged from punk in the 1980s, with the Emo movement following in the 1990s and 2000s. Both Goths and Emos were small but visually arresting groups. They had distinctive black clothing and pale make-up. Their tastes in music and culture often made them stand out against the bright and bubbly pop music of the Top 40 charts of the time.

Starter activity

Ask students about the popular culture they prefer, such as movies, TV shows, sports, music, art and books.

Do their friends like the same things? Are there groups that prefer different pop culture?

Use the discussion to introduce the idea that pop culture choices are often a way for groups to display a shared identity.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Bodgie, widgies and surfies', looks at two different groups in Australia's past. Students will write a diary entry from the perspective of each group, then consider the identities of different groups today.

The Activity sheet, 'Different views: Vietnam', provides two different views about conscription and the Vietnam War.

The Activity sheet 'Goths and Emos', introduces these two groups and explores the similarities and differences between them and their experiences of pop culture.

On the Activity sheet, 'Generations: Baby Boomers, X and Y', students read overviews of three generational groups: Baby Boomers, Generation X and Generation Y.

The Activity sheet, 'Pop culture and me', follows on from the previous Activity sheet. Students will complete a profile of Generation Z and consider the differences and similarities between generations.

Extension ideas

Have students work in small groups to put together a survey about cultural experiences. They should survey at least two people from each generation: Baby Boomers, X, Y and Z.

As a class, complete a comparison of pop culture across the generations. This could take the form of a graph, table or mind map.

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Bodgies, widgies and surfies

There have always been groups of people that wear similar clothes, listen to the same music and act in the same way. In the 1950s there were the bodgies (boys) and widgies (girls). In the 1960s and 1970s, there was the surfie culture.

Bodgies and widgies – 1950s	**Surfies – 1960s and 1970s**
• Adopted American culture • Rock'n' roll music like Bill Haley & His Comets • Hung out at milk bars and went to dances • Boys: hair in a ducktail style, wore leather jackets and denim jeans • Girls: short hair, wore stight black skirts with loose shirts • Some were seen as rebellious youth misbehaving	• American / Australian culture • Surf music like The Beach Boys • Hung out at the beach and went surfing • Boys: dyed their hair blonde, wore board shorts with thongs and sometimes a polo shirt • Girls: long blonde hair, bikinis with jeans and white shirts • Often drove panel vans • Seen as shiftless and lazy, focusing on fun rather than acting like adults

☞ **1** Imagine you are a bodgie or widgie. Write a diary entry about a typical weekend.

2 Write a diary entry about life as a surfie.

3 What culture groups are there today? What do they look like? What do they listen to, play and watch? Make a list in your workbook.

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Different views: Vietnam

Parents and children often think differently and have very different views on a particular issue. Part of this is due to growing up in different generations with different experiences.

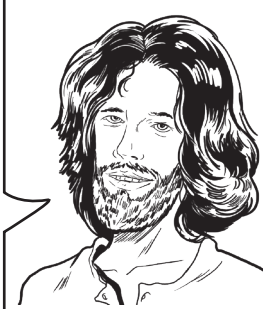
Conscription: When the government needs soldiers and makes a law to say that if you can fight, you have to join the military.

☞ Read what Doreen and Michael have to say about conscription and the Vietnam War.

Doreen

Reading the newspaper, I can scarcely believe the world we are living in. When my father was a young man he fought for our country. He He was only 19 and fought in the jungles of Borneo. Now with the Vietnam War and the fight against communism, we have all these kids trying to tell us that it is a 'dirty war'. They're just cowards. You didn't hear my dad complaining about being sent away to war. Now these boys are going around, burning their draft cards, saying they don't have to go. Makes you ashamed to be an Australian.

I can't go and fight. I just can't. They sent me my draft card the other day. My numbers had come up in the lottery for National Service and suddenly I have to go to another country and kill people who have never done anything to me. I'm not afraid. I know I will go to jail for this and I am not afraid of that. But - I am afraid of not being a good man. Of going to another country and forcing those people to be something other than what they want to be. You don't see the politicians going over to fight, but they tell us that we should go, and be proud. Well I am not proud. I cannot be proud of a country that does this.



Michael

1 Fill in the table.

	Views: How do they see the world?	Values: What do they think is important?
Doreen		
Michael		

2 Answer these questions in your workbook.

a When do you think conscription would be essential for a country?

b Imagine you have been conscripted. How would you feel? How would your family feel?

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Goths and Emos

☞ **1** Write the missing vowels (a, e, i, o, u) to complete the information.

Goths	Emos
• Start__d in the 1970s and 1980s and continues t__day • Nam__d after Gothic literat__re and buildings – gloomy, dark places • Target: young pe__ple who didn't fit into mainstream c__lture • Appear__nce: black hair and bl__ck clothes, clothing w__s often old-fashioned • Music: b__nds like Joy Division, The S__sters of Mercy and The Cure • Some p__ople believe that Goths 'hate every__ne'.	• Started in the 1990s and 2000s but l__ss popular tod__y • N__med for 'emotionally in t__uch' or 'emotional hard-core m__sic' • Target: yo__ng people who d__dn't fit into mainstream cult__re. • Appe__rance: dark hair, black cl__thing often inspir__d by sk__ter styles • Music: bands l__ke My Chemical Romance and Fall Out Boy • Some people bel__eve that Emos 'hate thems__lves'.

2 Complete the table with at least two points in each column.

Comparing Goths and Emos	
Similarities	**Differences**

3 What impact did these groups have on popular culture?

_____

_____

4 How do you think the way that Goths and Emos experienced popular culture in the 1980s–2000s was different to the way that other groups experienced it?

_____

_____

_____

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Achieve!

Generations: Baby Boomers, X and Y

People born in the same generation often share similar experiences: watching the same TV shows and movies, listening to the same music, falling in love with the same celebrities and experiencing many of the same political, social and cultural events.

☞ Use the word bank to complete the information.

Word bank: boom fantasy hire movies real rock'n'roll teenagers unique videos

Generation Baby Boomers, born 1947–1965

This was the first generation to be named. It reflected the population _____ just after World War II. They liked _____ music and were the first group to invent _____.

Movies: *The Graduate*, *Dirty Harry*, *Star Wars*, *The Godfather*

Celebrities: Gloria Gaynor, David Cassidy, Elvis, The Beatles, The Monkees

Events: Woodstock music festival 1969, Vietnam War 1955–75, Munich Olympics massacre 1972

Generation X, born 1963–1980

This was the first group who could watch _____ in their own homes. People could buy or _____ videos and record TV shows. The MTV channel was launched and musicians started making exciting and unusual music _____.

Movies: *The Breakfast Club*, *Reality Bites*, *Singles*, *Trainspotting*

Celebrities: Madonna, Michael Jackson, Nirvana, Michael Douglas, Winona Ryder

Events: Cold War 1945–1991, Destruction of the Berlin Wall 1989, HIV/AIDS crisis 1980s

Generation Y, born 1981–1994

This generation focused on _____ and science fiction – an escape from the '_____ world'. Everyone wanted to be _____, different and successful.

Movies: *Labyrinth*, *Empire Records*, *Star Wars 1: The Phantom Menace*, *Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone*

Celebrities: Hanson, Limp Bizkit, Backstreet Boys, Mariah Carey, Brad Pitt, Jennifer Anniston

Events: Nelson Mandela released 1990, Columbine High School massacre 1999, Twin Towers 2001

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Pop culture and me

☞ Use the Activity sheet, 'Generations: Baby boomers, X and Y', to complete the questions.

1 Using the previous Activity sheet as a model, complete the Generation Z profile based on your own knowledge of popular culture.

Generation Z, born 1995–2009

This is the first generation to grow up with the internet and no experience of life without computers, smartphones and tablets. Reality television is popular and many shows are based around the idea of instant celebrity status.

Movies: *Beauty and the Beast*, _____

_____

Celebrities: Beyoncé, _____

_____

Events: Death of Osama bin Laden 2011, Sandy Hook School massacre 2012, _____

_____

2 Write the matching generation in the box beside each film.

☐ *Harry Potter and the Philosopher's Stone* ☐ *Beauty and the Beast*

☐ *The Graduate* ☐ *Reality Bites* ☐ *The Breakfast Club* ☐ *Labyrinth*

3 List one defining feature of each generation.

Baby Boomers: _____

Generation X: _____

Generation Y: _____

4 Complete these activities in your workbook.

a Compare your own pop culture with the pop culture of a family member from a different generation. Outline the similarities and differences.

b 2010 marks the start of generation Alpha. What do you think this group will be like? Make a mind map to organise your ideas and then write a description.

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10 Teacher's notes – Pop culture and national identity

Achieve!

Objectives

- Consider how identities can be compared and contrasted
- Gain an understanding of how to structure an essay
- Identify how quotes can support an essay

Prior knowledge

Students need no prior knowledge for this unit.

Background

Popular culture helps to shape not only the community itself, but also the national identity. Originally, Australia was part of the Dreaming, a unique sense of identity shared by many Indigenous Australian peoples.

From 1788, the role of Indigenous Australia was diminished in mainstream history. The culture of Indigenous Australian people was both ignored and actively repressed. In the early 1900s, Indigenous Australian people were even seen as a 'doomed race', likely to become extinct.

It was the British who now controlled the Australian national identity, and then later the colonial governments. By the 1820s, these groups had become ashamed of the convict identity. The association of criminality tainted every Australian. This led to a celebration of the Australian bush, with a focus on the bushman as a uniquely Australian identity.

Later in the 1860s, Australia's urban centres were seen as a working man's paradise. This was because of the 'improved' working lives compared to Europe. Australia's identity had shifted towards being an egalitarian centre that promoted merit over class.

The year 1901 brought Federation, with the colonies joining to become the federal country of Australia. As a new country, there was a desire to create a new utopian society. This brought racist policies and laws as Australian federal politicians decided that their new egalitarian society should be for white people only. The *Immigration Restriction Act 1901* restricted non-European immigration to Australia to enforce this white Australian identity.

Concern about the lack of a strong national identity led many people to look to the Great War in 1914 (World War I). The Australian identity was then built around the camaraderie and larrikinism of the Anzac soldiers – an identity forged in the fields of Gallipoli and on the Western Front.

Although powerful, these national images excluded numerous groups: women, Indigenous Australian people, multicultural Australians and the LBGTIQ community. All were absent from the national image. It was only in the later half of the 20th century that the Australian identity began to include these groups and social acceptance of these groups still has a long way to go.

However, Australia has never quite let go of older identities such as the bushmen and the Anzac soldier. These identities still have a significant role in the Australian identity and this is reflected in films both past and present.

Starter activity

As a class, draw a mind map to show how students would define the modern Australian identity.

Resource sheets and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet, 'Australian identities', provides an overview of how the Australian identity is reflected and explored in Australian films. You can use Australian Screen Online (https://aso.gov.au) to watch clips from the films.

On the Activity sheet, 'Comparing identities', students choose two identities from the previous Resource sheet to compare and contrast.

In the Activity sheet, 'Essay plan', students are guided through the process of creating an essay plan using the information from the Resource sheet, 'Australian identities'.

Extension ideas

Practise writing essay questions.

First choose a topic related to pop culture.

- Include question/task words: who, what, where, when, why, how, discuss, analyse.
- Include your topic: groups, music, radio, television, films, fashion, books, technology; connections to pop culture, national identity, gender, children.
- Include key words: significance, context, cause, change, belief, role, develop, representation.
- Include a time period: 20th century, 1950s, 1970s, 1990s, 2000s.

Example: What (*question word*) was the role (*keyword*) of gender (*topic*) in Australian films in the 1970s (*time*)?

Web addresses were functional at the time of publication but teachers should check them for inappropriate content and to ensure that they are still functional before use with students.

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Australian identities

☞ **1** Read a synopsis (summary) of as many of the listed films as you can. You can also watch the films or clips from the films.

2 Make notes in your workbook to record what you find out about each identity.

Relevant films	Representation	Quote
Identity: Multicultural Australians		
They're a Weird Mob (1966) *Strictly Ballroom* (1992) *Footy Legends* (2006)	• 1960s: seen negatively, as 'other' • 1990s: sometimes idealised as the exotic other	Why don't you go back to your own bloody country? *They're a Weird Mob* A life lived in fear is a life half-lived. *Strictly Ballroom*
Identity: Bushmen		
Mad Max 2 (1981) *Crocodile Dundee* (1986)	• Lone men working in the bush • Taming the wild land • Fighting for their place	A man haunted by demons of his past, a man who wandered out into the wasteland. *Mad Max 2* That's not a knife. This is a knife. *Crocodile Dundee*
Identity: Unique individuals		
Muriel's Wedding (1994) *The Castle (*1997) *Kenny* (2006)	• Unique individuals trying to find a place in the world • Often find themselves as different or unusual compared to other people	You're terrible, Muriel! *Muriel's Wedding* I'd love to be able to say "I plumb toilets" and have someone say "Now that's something I've always wanted to do." *Kenny*
Identity: Indigenous Australian peoples		
Rabbit-Proof Fence (2002) *Ten Canoes (*2006) *Bran Nue Dae (*2010) *The Sapphires (*2012)	• Indigenous Australian history, including the Stolen Generations • Indigenous Australian people in the modern world	This is your new home. We don't use that jabber here. You speak English. *Rabbit-Proof Fence* Can you do it blacker? *The Sapphires*

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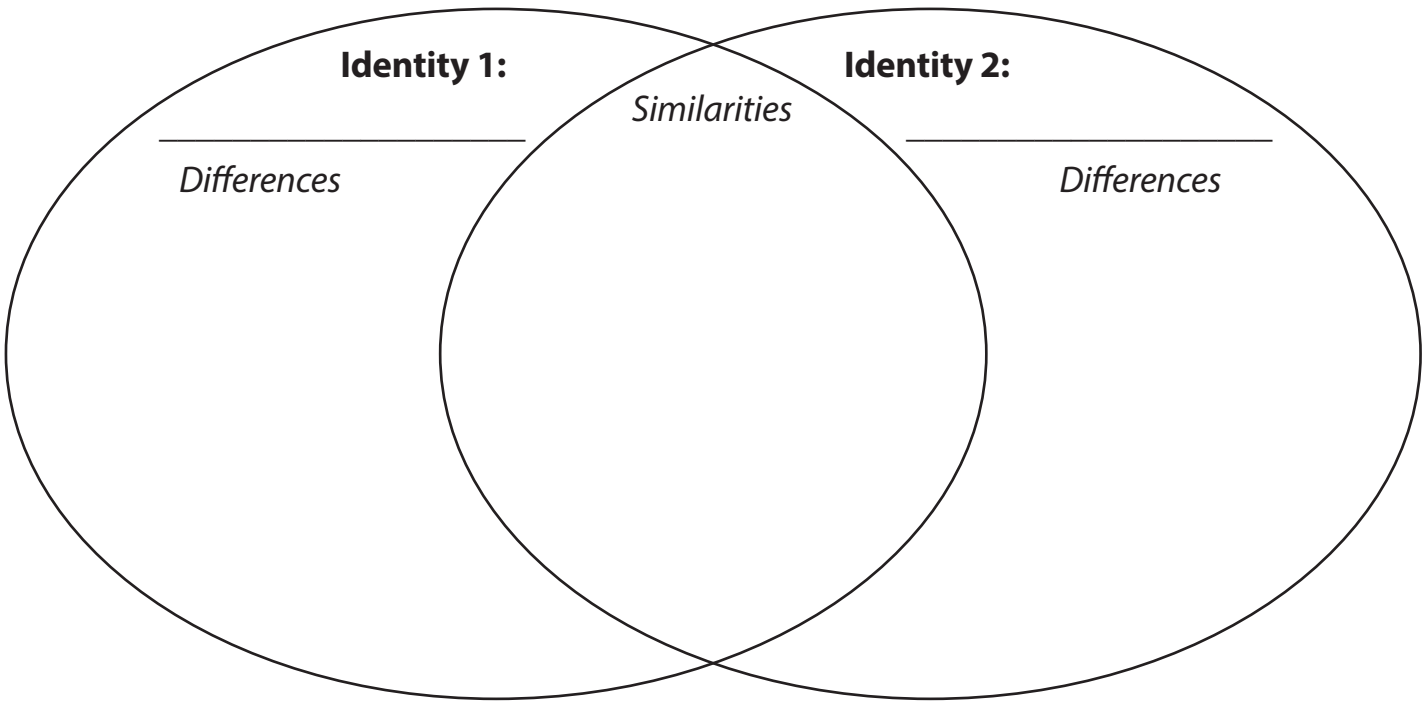
Comparing identities

Different countries have different national identities. These are certain qualities that all people from a country have in common.

The Australian identity has changed a lot over time. For most of our history, it has focused on white men. Only recently has this begun to change. Popular films can help us to see how cultural identity is defined, challenged and changed over time.

☞ **1** Choose two identities from the Resource sheet, 'Australian identities'. Complete the Venn diagram to show the similarities and differences between these identities.



2 Write a paragraph about your comparison of identities.
Include at least two words or phrases from the word bank.

Word bank

Similarities:
- also
- like
- similarly
- both

Differences:
- in contrast
- however
- although
- unlike

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Essay plan

Before you write an essay, you need a plan to help your essay make sense.

☞ Use the Resource sheet, 'Australian identities', to complete the plan below.

Essay question: How is the Australian identity explored in popular films? Discuss.

1 Highlight the keywords in the essay question. Write synonyms for these words.

_____

_____

2 In the following plan, you will see that some words are underlined. These are the essay keywords (e.g. identity, explore, Australian, popular, film) and body paragraph keywords (e.g. bushman, multicultural, unique individuals, Indigenous Australian) or synonyms for these keywords.

Make sure you use the keywords when you are completing the plan. This shows that you are answering the essay question. Highlight or underline the keywords you write to make it clear to yourself that you are using them.

Introduction

Rewrite the essay question.
(Hint: remove question words like 'What' from the essay question to make it a sentence.)

_____

_____

Discuss the topic in general, using keywords – Australia, although a young country, has had many different identities. These identities are explored in a number of popular films.

Introduce your four body paragraph topics:

1. Multicultural Australians

2. Bushmen

3. Unique individuals

4. Indigenous Australian peoples

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Essay plan continued

Body paragraph 1: Multicultural Australians

Topic sentence (introduces your body paragraph) – Australian films begin to explore multiculturalism as an Australian identity.

What was Australia's identity? Why did it have that identity?

Evidence – Australia's identity became more multicultural during the 20th century.

Explain – At first, migrants who were not from England were seen negatively, as 'other'.

How was this identity shown in films?

Evidence – 'A life lived in fear is a life half-lived.' *Strictly Ballroom*

Explain – Later in the 1990s, the multicultural identity was more accepted. Some migrants were seen as people who provided valuable skills and knowledge to Australia.

Mini-conclusion (sums up your body paragraph) – Initially, Australia's multicultural identity was problematic with films showing the negativity that migrants faced, but later films focused on the value of including people from many different cultures.

Body paragraph 2: Bushmen

Topic sentence – The colonial identity of the bushman was often reintroduced in films that celebrated lone men.

What was Australia's identity? Why did it have that identity?

Evidence – In the early days of European colonisation, there were few colonists and men often worked alone in the bush.

Explain – _____

How was this identity shown in films?

Evidence – _____

Explain – The main character in *Mad Max* always works alone, like the bushmen of the past.

Evidence – 'That's not a knife. This is a knife.' *Crocodile Dundee*

Explain – _____

Mini-conclusion (sums up your body paragraph) – _____

_____

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Essay plan continued

Body paragraph 3: Unique individuals

Topic sentence – _____

What was Australia's identity? Why did it have that identity?

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

How was this identity shown in films?

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

Mini-conclusion (sums up your body paragraph) – _____

_____

Body paragraph 4: Indigenous Australian peoples

Topic sentence – _____

What was Australia's identity? Why did it have that identity?

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

How was this identity shown in films?

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

Evidence – _____

Explain – _____

Mini-conclusion (sums up your body paragraph) – _____

_____

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Essay plan continued

Conclusion

Sum up the essay question – _____

_____

Your POV (Hint: This is your point of view or argument, whether you agree or disagree) –

_____

_____

Sum up body paragraph 1 – _____

_____

Sum up body paragraph 2 – _____

_____

Sum up body paragraph 3 – _____

_____

Sum up body paragraph 4 – _____

_____

Concluding statement (One powerful statement about the topic to finish on) –

_____

_____

Extra activity: Write an essay using this plan. There should be six paragraphs: an introduction, four body paragraphs and a conclusion.

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While very suitable for the regular classroom, the *Achieve!* series of History titles has been written at a literacy level that is appropriate for secondary school students who, because of poor reading skills, may struggle with regular classroom materials.

This title explores the changing ideas about the culture of ordinary people since World War II, including historians' opinions on the importance of pop culture, the effects of media technology on cultural products like fashion and film, and how Australia's national identity is represented in pop culture. Units about everyday issues like housing and holidays, subcultures, sport and censorship reflect the insights that historians can gain by studying pop culture. Students will examine key events such as the arrival of television in 1956 and the Vietnam War and consider pop culture from the perspectives of the Baby Boomers and Generations X, Y and Z. Students are also provided with a scaffolded activity to guide them through preparing an essay plan about representations of Australian identity in film.

The CD-ROM contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used in other work sheets. These files can be easily edited to suit the needs of students.

Topics include

- Introduction to popular culture
- Homes, holidays and healthy lives
- TV killed the radio star
- Music
- Cinema and censorship
- Sporting nation
- Fads, fashions, fast food and fiction
- Technology and culture
- Subcultures
- Pop culture and national identity

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